Tender for Setting up, Operations and Management of State Helpline

Reference number: DGGIT/Helpline/2025/2

Department of Good Governance and Information Technology,
Government of Punjab
Plot No. D-241, Industrial Area, Phase – 8B, Sector – 74,
Mohali – 160071

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1. Document control sheet

SN	Particulars	Details
1.	Document reference number.	DGGIT/Helpline/2025/2
2.	Date & time for the start of sale of e-tender	06.09.2025 13:00 Hrs
3.	Last date and time for submission of queries through email	11.09.2025, 17:00 hrs
4.	Date and time for pre-bid meeting	12.09.2025, 11:00 Hrs (Details will be updated on website)
5.	Last date and time for submission of bids	06.10.2025, 14:00 hrs
6.	Date and time of opening of pre-qualification bids	07.10.2025, 11:00 hrs
7.	Date and time of opening of technical / financial bids	To be intimated later
8.	Address for communication and venue for pre-bid meeting.	Department of Good Governance and Information Technology, Plot No. D-241, Industrial Area, Phase – 8B, Sector – 74, Mohali – 160071
9.	Cost of tender document to be paid online	Rs. 2,000/- (Rs. Two thousand only)
10.	Earnest Money Deposit (EMD) through online mode	Rs. 36,00,000/- (Rs. Thirty Six Lacs only)
11.	Contact details.	Name: Ranjit Singh Mobile : 9915215541 Email: ranjit.singh5@punjab.gov.in
12.	Website for reference	https://dit.punjab.gov.in/ and https://eproc.punjab.gov.in/
13.	Method of Selection.	Least Cost Based Selection (LCBS)

Note: All corrigendum / addendums / clarifications regarding this tender shall be posted on the above-mentioned websites only.

2. Definitions

2.1. Unless the context otherwise requires, the following terms whenever used in this tender and subsequent contract shall have the following meanings:

2.1.1. “AHT” means “Average Handle Time”.

2.1.2. “ACD” means “Automatic Call Distributor”.

2.1.3. “Bid” means a proposal submitted by a bidder in response to this tender.

2.1.4. “Bidder” means a business entity which submits a bid in response to this tender.

2.1.5. “Bid Evaluation Committee” means the committee constituted by the DGGIT for evaluation of bids.

2.1.6. “Contract” refers to the contract entered between the DGGIT and the Service Provider.

2.1.7. “CRM” means “Customer Relationship Management”.

2.1.8. “CCE” means Call Center Executive”

2.1.9. “Call Center Premises” refers to the physical location or facility where the call center shall operate. It refers to the entire space where the call center's activities take place, including the workspace for CCEs, support staff, management, meeting rooms, pantry/ canteen, dining area, toilets, parking space, etc.

2.1.10. “Call Center seat” refers to a dedicated workstation equipped with necessary hardware, software, and connectivity for a CCE to handle inbound and outbound call interactions.

2.1.11. “Call Center Solution” refers to the entire IT solutioning (hardware/software/any other tool/third party services) required for the operationalization of a call center as per scope of this tender, including but not limited to modules like CRM, IVRS, ACD, Voice Logger, CTI, PRI Line(s)/ SIP/ VOIP etc.

2.1.12. “Client” or “DGGIT” refers to the Department of Good Governance and Information Technology, Punjab.

2.1.13. “Day” refers to any calendar day of 24 hours

2.1.14. “EMD” means Earnest Money Deposit.

2.1.15. “Go-Live” means the contract stage when the Call Center and CRM application/Call center solution is made operational for the Call Center Executives and DGGIT is able to view the real time records with respect to Calls, agents etc. to log their case logs with respect to any Call, Email support, etc. case category.

2.1.16. “Inbound Call” refers to the calls received at the call center by the CCE from citizens for inquiry, information or lodging of grievances.

2.1.17. “IPR” means “Intellectual Property Rights”.

2.1.18. “IVRS” means Interactive Voice Response System

2.1.19. “Man Shift” means one continuous 8 hour work shift that shall be equal to one call center seat and which can be performed either by single CCE or in case of leave substitution or adjustment, jointly by a CCE and a Leave Reserve CCE.

2.1.20. "Outbound Call" refers to a call made from the Call Center to a citizen by the CCE for feedback collection, information dissemination, query resolution, or services support.

2.1.21. “PRI” means “Primary Rate Interface”.

2.1.22. “PBG” means “Performance Bank Guarantee”.

2.1.23. “PGRS” refers to Public Grievance Redressal System - A portal of Govt. of Punjab for registration, receipt and disposal of grievances of citizens.

2.1.24. “Service Provider" means the bidder selected through the competitive tendering process in pursuance of this tender.

2.1.25. “Similar work” refers to the operations and management of a call center with a minimum 300 seat capacity in single shift or multi-shift or 24x7 mode, providing inbound / outbound voice-based citizen support services for at least one year for a government or Public Sector Undertaking or large private organization.

2.1.26. “SLA” refers to “Service Level Agreement”.

2.1.27. ‘World Bank’: means the International Bank for Reconstruction and Development (IBRD) or the International Development Association (IDA).

2.1.28. ‘Anti-Corruption Guidelines’: The World Bank’s Guidelines on Preventing and Combating Fraud and Corruption in Program for Results Financing dated February 1, 2012 and revised July 10, 2015

3. Introduction

3.1. The Department of Good Governance and Information Technology, Punjab, administers the implementation of e-governance projects for the overall benefit of the citizens and public by setting up the necessary administrative, financial, legal, and technical framework, implementation mechanism, and resources in the State of Punjab.

3.2. The Government of Punjab envisioned a common Unified State Helpline number for government departments by merging all the existing non-emergency services. With this objective, a 24x7 call center with capacity of 100 man shifts per day (scalable up to 200 man shifts per day) for Unified State Helpline no. 1100 was established in 2024, which is being operated and managed through a private service provider. Further, another call center, mainly for outbound calling, is being set up with a capacity of 800 man shifts per day. However, it has been observed that these call centres will fall short of the required number of outbound calls to citizens for garnering feedback/ information dissemination.

3.3. Accordingly, it has been decided to procure services of two additional call centers operating with a cumulative 1,000 man shifts per day with a minimum payment guarantee of 50% in each case. There may be 25% overall variation upwards in the total number of man shifts. The 1,000 man shifts shall be divided into the two call centres in the ratio of 60:40 (amongst L1 and L2 bidders) (methodology for division is covered in Clause 4.12).

3.4. Through this RFP, the government intends, inter alia, to make outbound calls to citizens for purposes such as collection of citizen feedback/ survey as well as information dissemination about the Government Schemes. The Service Provider may however be required to accept inbound calling too, if so required by the Client, at no extra cost to the Client.

4. Instructions to bidders

4.1. Bid evaluation process

4.1.1. The bid evaluation will be carried out in a three-stage process as under:

a. Pre-qualification / eligibility evaluation
b. Technical bids evaluation
c. Financial bids evaluation

4.1.2. In the first stage of evaluation, the pre-qualification proposal of all bidders shall be evaluated to determine whether the bidder satisfies the pre-qualification criteria. At the end of this stage, the DGGIT shall publish online on the e-procurement portal (https://eproc.punjab.gov.in), the list of bidders that satisfy pre-qualification criteria (the "Qualified Bidders") for the next stage i.e. technical evaluation.

4.1.3. In the second stage of evaluation, the technical proposal of only qualified bidders from the first stage will be opened and evaluated for the purpose of identifying the bidders meeting the technical criteria ("Technically Qualified Bidders"). The technical proposals and financial proposals of the non-qualified bidders shall not be opened.

4.1.4. In the third stage of evaluation, the financial proposal of only technically qualified bidders from the second stage will be opened and evaluated for the purpose of identifying the successful bidder(s). The financial proposals of the bidders not declared as technically qualified bidders shall not be opened.

4.1.5. During the process of evaluation of bids, the DGGIT may, at its discretion, ask bidders for clarifications on their bids. Bidders are required to respond within the prescribed time frame given for submission of such clarification otherwise the Committee shall make its own reasonable assumptions at the total risk and cost of the bidder and the bid may lead to rejection.

4.2. Pre-qualification / Eligibility evaluation

4.2.1. The evaluation of the bidders will be carried out by the Committee as per the pre-qualification / eligibility criteria defined in the tender document. Only the bidders who fulfill the given pre-qualification / eligibility criteria shall be eligible for the next round of evaluation i.e. technical bid opening. Non-conforming bids will be rejected and will not be eligible for any further processing.

4.2.2. The eligibility criteria are given as below: -

SN	Eligibility Criteria	Supporting documents
1.	Bidder should be either: ● A company registered under the Indian Companies Act, 2013 OR ● A partnership firm registered under the Limited Liability Partnerships (LLP) Act, 2008 OR ● A partnership firm registered under the Indian Partnership Act, 1932 Note: Consortium / JV is not allowed	Certificate of Incorporation, or Certificate of Registration, or Partnership deed, or constitution documents as per applicable laws etc.
2.	Should be in business for more than 3 years as on last date of bid submission	Certificate from statutory auditor / practicing Chartered Accountant having UDIN / work order OR Any other relevant proof
3.	The bidder should have successfully completed “Similar Work” in government /Public Sector Undertaking/ private organizations during the last five years ending 31.08.2025 as per following details:- A. Annual cost of one similar work is not less than the amount equal to Rs. 12 crores. OR B. Annual cost of two similar works is not less than the amount equal to Rs. 9 crores each. OR C. Annual cost of three similar works is not less than the amount equal to Rs. 6 crores each.	1. For completed projects: a. Project citation supported with Work order / Client Certificate / Work order along with certificate from CA / Statutory Auditor certifying number of seats. 2. For projects in progress in which minimum 1 year has been completed: a. Project citation supported with Work order / Client Certificate / Work order along with certificate from CA / Statutory Auditor certifying number of seats. b. Client certificate/ Invoice Copy (with CA certificate specifying number of seats) or any other relevant proof mentioning work order details, completion of at least 1 year of

SN	Eligibility Criteria	Supporting documents
		activity.
4.	The Bidder must have an average annual turnover of above INR 25 crores in the following financial years - FY 2021-22, FY 2022-23 and FY 2023-24	Audited Financial Statements with Certificate from statutory auditors having UDIN clearly certifying the turnover OR CA certificate having UDIN clearly certifying the turnover
5.	The Bidder should have positive net worth in the following financial years - FY 2021-22, FY 2022-23 and FY 2023-24	Certificate from the Statutory Auditor/ Practicing Chartered Accountant, having UDIN, depicting the Net worth/Cash flow for each year.
6.	The bidder shall submit an undertaking of not being under declaration of blacklisting, insolvency and conviction for any criminal offense as on last date of bid submission	Self - certified letter as per Annexure 10.3
7.	The bidder should have a valid GST registration certificate and PAN/TAN in the name of the bidder.	Self - certified copy of relevant valid certificates
8.	The bidder must ensure to deposit the tender document fees and EMD in online mode only at https://eproc.punjab.gov.in/	Any relevant proof
9.	Registered with EPF Organization and ESI Corporation	Copy of EPF and ESI registration certification

4.2.3. Bidders registered as a startup with Department of Industries & Commerce, Government of Punjab as per chapter 16.1 of Detailed Scheme & Operational Guidelines, 2018 of Industrial and Business Development Policy 2017, issued by Department of Industries & Commerce, Government of Punjab, shall be exempted from eligibility criteria mentioned at Sr. No. 2 - 5 in the table mentioned above. Registered startups are required to submit the self attested copy of the registration in order to avail the relaxations.

4.2.4. The Bid Covering Letter as per format 9.1 and compliance against the above criteria in the same format & same sequence of PQ section of the tender with

attached submitted documents and its page number reference for validation is to be submitted as per below format: -

SN	Particulars	Eligibility Criteria	Supporting Documents	Pg. No.	Compliance (Yes / No)
...	...	...	...	...	...

4.3. Technical Evaluation

4.3.1. The evaluation of the bidders will be carried out by the committee as per the technical evaluation criteria. Only the bidders who fulfill the given technical criteria shall be eligible for the financial bid opening.

4.3.2. Technical evaluation criteria are as under:

SN	Criteria	Max Marks	Supporting Document Required
1.	**Organizational Financial Strength** Average Annual Turnover (AT) in the following financial years - FY 2021-22, FY 2022-23 and FY 2023-24: ● AT >= INR 25 crores, but < INR 50 crores : **10 marks**; ● AT >= INR 50 crores, but < INR 75 crores : **13 marks**; ● AT >= INR 75 crores : **15 marks**	15	Audited Financial Statements with Certificate from statutory auditors having UDIN clearly certifying the turnover OR CA certificate having UDIN clearly certifying the turnover
2.	**Past Experience (No. of Projects of "Similar Work")** Number of "Similar Works" within the following financial years - FY 2022-23, FY 2023-24 and FY 2024-25 with not less than 300 seats each: ● 1 projects : **10 Marks** ● 2 projects : **13 Marks** ● 3 or more projects : **15 Marks**	15	1. For completed projects: a. Project citation supported with Work order / Client Certificate / Work order along with certificate from CA / Statutory Auditor certifying number of seats**.** 2. For projects in progress in which minimum 1 year has been completed: a. Project citation supported with Work order / Client Certificate / Work order along with certificate

SN	Criteria	Max Marks	Supporting Document Required
			from CA / Statutory Auditor certifying number of seats. b. Client certificate/ Invoice Copy (with CA certificate specifying number of seats) or any other relevant proof mentioning work order details, completion of at least 1 year of activity.
3.	No. of successfully completed "Similar Work" in government /Public Sector Undertaking/ private organizations during the last five years ending 31.08.2025 as per following details:- ● 1 project of minimum Rs. 12 crore or 2 projects of minimum Rs. 9 crore each or 3 projects of minimum Rs. 6 crore each: **15 marks** ● 2 projects of minimum Rs. 12 crore or 3 projects of minimum Rs. 9 crore each or 4 projects of minimum Rs. 6 crore each: **17 marks** ● 3 projects of minimum Rs. 12 crore or 4 projects of minimum Rs. 9 crore each or 5 projects of minimum Rs. 6 crore each: **20 marks**	20	1. For completed projects: a. Project citation supported with Work order / Client Certificate / Work order along with certificate from CA / Statutory Auditor certifying number of seats**.** 2. For projects in progress in which minimum 1 year has been completed: a. Project citation supported with Work order / Client Certificate / Work order along with certificate from CA / Statutory Auditor certifying number of seats. b. Client certificate/ Invoice Copy (with CA certificate specifying number of seats) or any other relevant proof mentioning work order details, completion of at least 1 year of activity.
4.	CCE on payrolls of the bidder as on date of bid submission: ● >=400 but < 500 : **10 marks** ● >=500 but < 750 : **13 marks** ● >= 750 : **15 marks**	15	Undertaking by HR Head / PF-ESI statements

SN	Criteria	Max Marks	Supporting Document Required
5.	**Profit Making**: Number of FYs for which the Bidder has been a profit-making entity in the following financial years - FY 2021-22, FY 2022-23 and FY 2023-24: ● Any one FY : **10 Marks** ● Any two FYs : **13 marks** ● All three FYs : **15 Marks**	15	Profit & Loss Statement for the concerned financial year along with the Certificate from the statutory auditor/ Practicing Chartered Accountant clearing mentioning the profit, having UDIN.
6.	Number of years for which the bidder has been in business as on last date of bid submission: ● >= 3 & < 5 : **2 marks** ● >=5 & < 7 : **3 marks** ● >=7 : **5 marks**	5	Certificate from statutory auditor / practicing Chartered Accountant having UDIN / work order/Certificate of Incorporation
7.	**ISO 9001 Certificate** The bidder possesses ISO 9001 certification which should be valid on the date of bid : **5 Marks**	5	Certificate which is valid on the date of bid submission.
8.	**ISO 27001 Certificate** The bidder possesses ISO 27001 certification which should be valid on the date of bid : **5 Marks**	5	Certificate which is valid on the date of bid submission.
9.	The Bidder is registered with the Department of Telecom (DoT), Government of India, under OSP category for providing domestic call center services : **5 Marks**	5	Registration Certificate which is valid on the date of bid submission
Total		**100**	

4.3.3. Only those Bidders whose absolute technical score is 60 or more shall be considered by the DGGIT for further evaluation i.e. financial bid evaluation.

4.3.4. The DGGIT shall award marks based on documents submitted and the decision of the DGGIT regarding the marks awarded shall be final and binding on the bidders. It shall be the sole responsibility of the bidder to submit all supporting documents as mentioned in the above table at the time of bid submission.

4.4. Earnest Money Deposit (EMD)

4.4.1. The bidder shall furnish the Earnest Money Deposit (EMD) either through online mode, as part of the Eligibility Criteria, in accordance with the details provided in the Document Control Sheet.

4.4.2. EMD of the successful bidder will be released after the successful bidder signs the final contract and furnishes the Performance Security.

4.4.3. EMD of the bidders whose bid is rejected in technical evaluation shall be returned upon the completion of technical evaluation.

4.4.4. EMD of all the remaining bidders, except the successful bidder, shall be returned upon the completion of financial evaluation.

4.4.5. EMD of the successful bidder shall be returned, without any interest, upon receipt of the required Performance Security within the stipulated time. If the successful bidder fails to furnish the required Performance Security within the specified period, the EMD shall be forfeited, and the contract may be awarded to the next eligible bidder.

4.4.6. The EMD submitted shall be interest-free and will be refundable to the bidders without any accrued interest on it.

4.4.7. The EMD will be forfeited on account of one or more of the following reasons: -

a. Bidder withdraws the bid during the validity period specified in the tender.
b. If a bidder makes misleading or false representations in the forms, statements and attachments submitted in the bid documents.
c. If the bidder breaches any provision of code of conduct and integrity as prescribed for bidder in this document.
d. In case of a successful bidder, the said bidder fails to sign the contract in time; or furnish Performance Security in time.

4.5. Clarification on Tender document

4.5.1. The bidders requiring any clarification on the bid document may submit their queries by the due date and time as mentioned in the Document Control Sheet in the following format in a MS Excel file:

SN	Tender Clause No.	Pg. No.	Tender Clause detail	Amendment Sought / Suggestion	Justification
…	…	…	…	…	…

4.6. Preparation of bid

4.6.1. The bidder is expected & deemed to have carefully examined all the instructions, guidelines, forms, requirements, appendices, and other information along with all the bid's terms and conditions and other formats. Failure to furnish all the necessary information as required by the bid or submission of a proposal not substantially responsive to all the requirements of the bid shall be at the bidder's own risk and may be liable for rejection.

4.6.2. The bidders need to assess the quantum of work involved before submitting the bid. Once the bid is submitted, it will be presumed that the bidder has seen and understood the complete Scope of Work.

4.6.3. The bid shall be uploaded on the www.eproc.punjab.gov.in website by the bidder or duly authorized person(s) to bind the bidder to the contract.

4.6.4. The bidder shall be responsible for all costs incurred in connection with participation in the bid process.

4.6.5. The bids submitted by fax / e-mail / envelope etc. shall not be accepted. No correspondence will be entertained on this matter.

4.6.6. The bids submitted by a consortium of companies / firms or any subcontractors will be rejected.

4.6.7. All correspondences between the bidders and DGGIT shall be written in the English language.

4.6.8. All information supplied by bidders shall be treated as contractually binding on the bidders on the successful award of the assignment by DGGIT on the basis of this Tender.

4.6.9. Failure to comply with the below requirements shall lead to the bid rejection:

a. Comply with all requirements as set out within this Tender.
b. Submission of the forms and other particulars as specified in this Tender and respond to each element in the order as set out in this Tender.
c. Submission of all supporting documentation specified in this Tender, corrigendum or any addendum issued.

4.7. Deviations

4.7.1. Bids submitted with any deviations to the contents of this Tender Document will be considered as non-responsive. No deviation(s) / assumption(s) / recommendation(s) shall be allowed with the bid. Bidders must ensure that the pre-bid meeting is attended by their concerned senior people / representative so that all clarifications and assumptions are resolved before bid submission.

4.8. Validity of bids

4.8.1. Bids shall remain valid till 90 (ninety) days from the date of submission of bids. DGGIT reserves the right to reject a proposal valid for a shorter period.

4.8.2. If required, DGGIT may solicit the bidder's consent to extend the period of validity. The request and the response thereto shall be made in writing. Extension of validity period by the bidder should be unconditional. A bidder may refuse the request without forfeiting the Earnest Money Deposit. A bidder granting the request will not be permitted to modify its bid.

4.8.3. The DGGIT reserves the right to annul the Tender process, or to accept or reject any or all the bids in whole or part at any time without assigning any reasons and without incurring any liability to the affected bidder(s) or any obligation to inform the affected bidder(s) of the grounds for such decision.

4.9. Amendment to the Tender document

4.9.1. Amendments / corrigendum / addendums / clarifications necessitated due to any reasons, shall be made available on the website only as provided in the document control sheet. No separate communication either in writing or through email will be made to any interested/ participating bidders. It shall be the responsibility of the bidders to regularly visit and check the websites (https://dit.punjab.gov.in/ and https://eproc.punjab.gov.in/) for updates.

4.9.2. In order to provide prospective bidders reasonable time for taking the corrigendum(s) or addendum(s) into account, DGGIT, at its discretion, may extend the last date for the submission of bids.

4.10. Submission of Bid

4.10.1. The bid submitted by the bidder shall comprise of:

a. Pre-Qualification proposal;
b. Technical proposal; and

c. Financial proposal

4.10.2. Bidders are required to upload bid documents as per terms & conditions of this tender and attach PQ and TQ checklist.

4.10.3. Bidders shall submit their bid through e-procurement portal on or before the last date and time for submission of bids as per bid data sheet. It is advised that bidders may submit their bids well in advance of the stipulated time so as to avoid last minute hiccups.

4.10.4. The bids that are uploaded online on e-procurement portal will only be considered for bid evaluation unless the bid evaluation committee has asked for revised documents in case of any clarification/additional information pertaining to submitted documents sought during bid evaluation.

4.11. Bid opening

4.11.1. The DGGIT will constitute a committee to evaluate the bids submitted by bidders. No correspondence will be entertained outside the process of evaluation with the Committee.

4.11.2. The bids submitted will be opened at time & date as specified in the document control sheet by Committee or any other officer authorized by Committee, in the presence of bidders or their representatives who may wish to be present at the time of bid opening.

4.12. Financial bid format and evaluation

4.12.1. Bidders shall submit their cost in the below format:

Table 1

SN	Description of service	Unit price per month including GST (Rs.)
1.	8 hour man shift	

Note: Payment shall be released on the actual number of 8 hour man shifts. All replacement/ relever/ leave reserve should be accommodated in the price to be quoted. No extras shall be payable for this.
No decimal values allowed. If mentioned, the decimal part shall be discarded.

4.12.2. Bidders must quote charges per 8 hour man shift for a full month. Incomplete financial bids shall be rejected.

4.12.3. The bidder shall provide a bundled cost for every 8 hour man shift that comprehensively includes all expenses related to manpower (including CCEs, Project Managers, Team Leaders cum Trainers, and all supporting staff), facility costs (covering office premises, whether rented, leased, or owned, along with maintenance charges), technology infrastructure (encompassing both IT and non-IT equipment, software, internet connectivity, CRM including customizations, API integrations, etc), telecommunication services (including PRI lines, inbound and outbound calling plan subscriptions encompassing all associated costs, service fees, regulatory charges etc.), and any other components essential for delivering the complete Call Center Solution. No additional costs beyond the quoted rates shall be claimable during contract execution. This shall also include the cost of reliever/ leave reserve manpower as well.

4.12.4. A cost escalation of 5% per annum shall be permitted from the completion of successful operation of each year.

4.12.5. Financial bids would be opened for only those bidders who qualify for all the technical evaluation criteria as mentioned in this document on the prescribed date in the presence of the bidders' representatives, who may wish to be present.

4.12.6. The bids will be evaluated on the Least Cost Based Selection method for prices mentioned in **Table 1**. The lowest bid for **Table 1** shall be declared as the most responsive bidder (L1). The next lowest bid shall be declared as L2 bidder and so on.

4.12.7. In case of a tie, the bidder having the highest technical score (T) among such bidders will be considered.

4.12.8. In case of a tie of the technical score, the bidder having the highest annual turnover in the last financial year, FY 2024-25, shall be considered.

4.12.9. L1 bidder will be eligible for allocation of maximum man-shifts of 600. Next, L2 will be asked if they are ready to undertake the work of a maximum 400 man-shifts at L1 rates. In case of refusal, L3 shall be asked the same and so on. In case, all bidders who quoted higher than L1 bidder refuse to undertake the work, L1 shall be asked the same.

4.12.10. If the bidders to whom the work is allocated are unable to provide the services in full or in part, their LoI shall be canceled, their EMD and/or performance security shall be forfeited, and the client reserves the right to take appropriate action against the service provider.

4.12.11. Failure to abide by the tender conditions may result in forfeiture of EMD & performance security.

4.12.12. Any conditional financial bid will lead to disqualification of the entire bid and forfeiture of the EMD.

4.12.13. The bidders quoting zero or negative charges in the financial bid will be treated as non-responsive, and their EMD shall be forfeited.

4.13. Disqualifications

DGGIT may at its sole discretion and at any time during the evaluation of bids, disqualify any bidder, if the bidder has:-

4.13.1. Made misleading or false representations in the forms, statements and attachments submitted in bid documents. The EMD of the bidder will be forfeited in such cases.

4.13.2. Exhibited a record of poor performance such as abandoning works, not properly completing the contractual obligations, inordinately delaying completion or financial failures, etc. in any project in the preceding three years.

4.13.3. Failed to provide clarifications related thereto, when sought.

4.13.4. Submitted more than one bid (directly / indirectly).

4.13.5. Declared ineligible by the Government of India / State / UT Government for corrupt and fraudulent practices or blacklisted.

4.13.6. Submitted a bid with price adjustment/variation provision.

4.13.7. Documents are not submitted as specified in the tender document.

4.13.8. Suppressed any details related to bid.

4.13.9. Submitted incomplete information, subjective, conditional offers and partial offers submitted.

4.13.10. Not submitted documents as mentioned in this tender.

4.13.11. Submitted bid with lesser validity period.

4.13.12. Any non-adherence/non-compliance to applicable tender content.

4.14. Issue of Letter of Intent (LoI)

4.14.1. DGGIT will issue a Letter of Intent (LoI) to notify the successful bidder(s) in writing about acceptance of their bid. The LoI will constitute the formation of the contract after submission of performance security to DGGIT by the successful bidder.

4.15. Performance security

4.15.1. The successful bidder(s) shall furnish “Fixed Performance Security” to DGGIT valued at 5% of the contract value (calculated as “Monthly cost per 8 hour man shift)” * 300 call center seats * Total contract period (in months) within 15 days from the date of signing of contract in the form of Performance Bank Guarantee / NEFT / DD.

4.15.2. The successful bidder(s) shall also furnish a “Variable Performance Security” to DGGIT in case of an increase in the number of call center seats beyond the initial seats. The Variable Performance Security shall be calculated as 5% of "Monthly cost per call center seat (of 8 hour man shift)” * Number of additional seats * (Total Contract Period (in months) – Number of completed months of the contract)". Any fractional part of the number of completed months shall be rounded up to the next whole number.

4.15.3. The Variable Performance Security shall be submitted within 15 days of such increase in call center being notified by DGGIT, in the form of a Performance Bank Guarantee / NEFT / Demand Draft. In the event of a reduction in the number of call center seats, DGGIT shall return the corresponding portion of the Variable Performance Security to the Service Provider, after reconciliation of monthly invoices and settlement of any applicable deductions.

4.15.4. Performance security shall remain valid for a period of 180 (one hundred eighty) days beyond the expiry of the contract. Whenever the contract is extended, the Service Provider will have to extend the validity of Performance security proportionately.

4.15.5. In case the successful bidder fails to submit performance security within the time stipulated, DGGIT at its discretion may cancel the award of contract to the successful bidder without giving any notice and the EMD of the concerned bidder will be forfeited.

4.15.6. The Service Provider will not be entitled for any interest on the performance security submitted.

4.15.7. DGGIT shall forfeit the performance security in full or in part in the following cases:

a. When the terms and conditions of contract are breached/ infringed.
b. When the contract is being terminated due to non-performance of the Service Provider.
c. DGGIT incurs any loss due to Service Provider’s negligence in carrying out the project implementation as per the agreed terms & conditions

4.16. Signing of contract

4.16.1. The successful bidder shall sign the contract with the DGGIT within 15 days of the issue of LoI. After signing of the contract, no variation in or modification of the terms of the contract shall be made except by mutual written amendment signed by both the parties.

5. Scope of Work

5.1. Introduction

5.1.1. The broad scope of work including but not limited to, is as under:

a. Establishing a state-of-the-art State Helpline Call Center in S.A.S. Nagar / Amritsar / Ludhiana / Jalandhar / Chandigarh primarily equipped for outbound call services, with provisions for inbound call facilities as well, if required later by the client. There shall be two additional call centers operating with a cumulative 1,000 man shifts per day with a minimum payment guarantee of 50% in each case. There may be 25% overall variation upwards in the total number of man shifts. The 1,000 man shifts shall be divided into the two call centres in the ratio of 60:40 (amongst L1 and L2 bidders) (methodology for division is covered in Clause 4.12).

b. The Call Center shall operate from 09:00 AM to 07:00 PM initially. The operational hours may be extended as per the requirements of the Client.

c. Deployment of required trained manpower well versed in Punjabi, Hindi & English for day-to-day operation of the call center.

d. Providing all IT and non-IT infrastructure of the call center. All civil and electrical works, including electricity, water, internet connection, IT hardware, software, audio/video equipment, proper housekeeping & cleanliness, etc., as required for setting up and running the call center smoothly, shall be in the scope of the service provider with no additional cost to the DGGIT. The Client may specify a specific helpline number or a series.

e. Providing outbound calling facilities with technologies such as computer telephony integration, Automatic Call Distributor, and call diversion/forwarding facility etc, call recordings with live access to DGGIT for hearing and quality assurance, customized live dashboards for analytics and report generation such as call reports and analysis, etc and CRM for data entry and processing with integration capabilities.

f. Operations and maintenance of the call center.

g. The infrastructure of the call center shall be capable of accommodating all the CCE in a single shift.

5.2. Call Center Solution

5.2.1. The Service Provider shall be responsible for providing all infrastructure elements for operating the Call Center Solution of the State Helpline which shall include but not limited to premises, requisite licenses, telecom infrastructure, third party software/tools/licenses, hardware related to telecom services, high-speed internet/network connection, switches, PBX, network security sub-system, ACD, Call Logger, reporting system, CRM Software, CRM database server(s) and requisite software, Call Server(s), CCE client machines, storage, LAN connections with cabling, high definition and noise cancellation headsets, desktops, mouse, keyboard, power, lighting, air conditioning (maintained between 24°C to 27°C), heating etc. and any other hardware/software required for handling calls & back-end operation of State Helpline.

5.2.2. The service provider shall provide each Call Center Executive (CCE) with high-quality headsets equipped with Environmental Noise Cancellation (ENC) microphones and adaptive Active Noise Cancellation (ANC) for superior audio clarity. The headsets must include an integrated microphone and a mute button to ensure effective and disturbance-free communication during calls.

5.2.3. The Service Provider will provide workstations to be connected to local servers / cloud servers (mandatorily from any of the MeitY empanelled Cloud Service Provider) with adequate performance (including storage, speed, etc.), to be used by the CCE(s)/other staff for accessing CRM/Dialer/etc. for operations of this Call Center. The minimum specification of Desktop provided to all CCE(s) is at Annexure 10.5

5.2.4. The Service Provider shall be responsible to provide and manage necessary telephony lines (PRI)/SIP/VOIP etc. for handling outbound calls and inbound calls (if required) and or any other number as decided by DGGIT. The cost of procuring, installing, and maintaining these lines shall be borne entirely by the Service Provider. The system architecture should be designed by the bidder in such a way that it meets the requirements of the project and the performance including service levels and other requirements as stated in this tender.

5.2.5. The Service Provider shall ensure that the computer system or any other equipment provided to CCE(s) for handling the operations of the call center process under this tender shall have restricted access and no personal activity shall be allowed on such system. Also, there should be restrictions at the hardware level to not allow connection of any personal device on such a system.

5.2.6. The Service Provider shall ensure that the CCE(s) shall not take away any data/customer information/government information related to this process by any means.

5.2.7. The Service Provider and DGGIT shall work together for two-way API integration of call center solution CRM & PGRS or any other Department Portals for capturing data into CRM, grievance submission, tracking, analytical activities, feedback result to Departments Dashboards or any other Portals and any other requirement to be performed by the Service Provider for dashboard contents as directed by the DGGIT.

5.2.8. The ownership and responsibility of operations and maintenance of all physical hardware, software and licenses including related services associated with State Helpline, shall remain with the Service Provider throughout the contract period. The Service Provider shall upgrade the software/technology to the latest version as per requirement or industry standards at no additional cost to the DGGIT.

5.2.9. The Service Provider will ensure adequate backup (fail over) server(s) along with the required servers, as part of business continuity plan, for running smooth processes and operations for the scope of this project.

5.2.10. Data Security & associated regulatory compliance for handling the data, shall be done by Service Provider. The related audit process(es) shall be conducted by the Service Provider, and submit a certified/self-certified report with supporting documentation/artifacts in this regard.

5.2.11. The Service Provider needs to ensure that any data which is provided by the DGGIT or data generated during the operations of the process or information / data received in handover from the previous vendor or any other data which is related to the project including reports, call recordings, call logs, emails, personal information, such as but not limited to names, addresses, contact details etc. of the citizens during the tenure of the project needs to be retained throughout the tenure of the project and handed over to the DGGIT at the end of the Project and the Service Provider must not use that data for any purpose other than mandated by the DGGIT. DGGIT may initiate a legal action as may be revealed from the nature of breach. DGGIT may also blacklist the Service Provider in-case it fails to provide full/partial data to the DGGIT.

5.2.12. The Service Provider will provide following preventive support:

a. Preventive maintenance of equipment(s).
b. Virus scans and Anti-virus updates (virus prevention, anti-virus updating and distribution).
c. Regular Backups (Onsite and Offsite backup planning).

d. Security policy creation & monitoring (Local Network Security, Application-Level Security including authentication and Authorization etc., OS Level Security, Physical Security, workstations, etc.).

5.2.13. Install safety mechanisms to prevent unauthorized access and manipulation of the technical systems and data.

5.2.14. Information Security - The Service Provider shall not carry and/ or transmit any written material, information, layouts, diagrams, storage media (hard disk/ tapes) or any other goods/ materials in physical or electronic form, out of State Helpline premises without prior consent from the DGGIT.

5.2.15. The requirements mentioned in this document are indicative and the Service Provider shall develop & deploy additional solutions and features as per the requirement of the DGGIT from time to time.

5.2.16. **Computer Telephony Integration (CTI)**

a. The CTI should be capable of integrating seamlessly with the call center solution and the Client's PGRS portal.
b. The CTI must be capable of activating the fast-dialing feature of the ACD.
c. Call events should be handled from the system such as hold, retrieve hold, conference, transfer etc. On transferring the call to another CCE the screen too should be transferred to that CCE's screen.
d. The CTI link shall have the ability to pass events and information of agent states and changes in agent states as well as incoming calls to the computer applications. For example, if the citizen calls from the same no. from which he had called earlier (registered/unregistered), the CTI platform shall be able to automatically fetch and display at least the last 5 service requests details of that citizen.
e. The offered CTI platform shall support a set of APIs which support TAPI / TSAPI / JTAPI / .Net framework / API.
f. CTI should perform in both preview dialing mode and progressive dialing mode and also perform following functions including but not limited to
    i) It indicates that the call has entered the setup phase.
    ii) Call is connected or delivered to CCE when the call starts ringing.
    iii) Call establishes when a call is answered.
    iv) Call is cleared when the voice connection is terminated.
    v) Call is completely ended when the logical call appearance (including call data) is complete

5.2.17. **Automatic Call Distributor (ACD) (in case of inbound calling)**

ACD responsible for distribution of incoming calls to CCEs should have the following features, but not limited to:

a. Standard features like Call Transfer, Conference, Barge in, Dialed Number Identification Sequence (DNIS), Automatic Number Identification (ANI), Caller Line Identification (CLI), etc.
b. Handle high call volumes efficiently.
c. Should be able to connect a citizen calling from a previously used number (registered/ unregistered) to one of the last 5 agents (recent agent interacted gets higher priority) interacting based on the availability of the agent. If none of the previous agents are available, the standard process follows.
d. Provide the capability of combining data with the Interactive Voice Response System, (IVRS) menu system that can intelligently route calls requesting further assistance to a smart Automatic Call Distributor (ACD).
e. Provide a highly configurable system for adding/removing users and assigning users to different queues.
f. The system should support skill based routing, multiple group support, priority handling and queue status indicator.
g. The system should be able to intelligently route the callers to CCE's as defined by the DGGIT.
h. Allow calls to be transferred within the call center.
i. The system should support assigning higher priority on calls to certain trunk groups or to certain dialed numbers than other calls, and the calls which overflow from another split be queued ahead of other calls.
j. Offered IVRS applications should support open standards based development environments such as Voice XML, CCXML for simpler integration with existing web and enterprise applications.

5.2.18. **Other Features**

a. The IVRS should be customizable & multi level and shall be able to link ACD, call recording etc. to information held on a CRM database about the inbound caller.
b. It should be able to support the following information messages and options that are related to voice callers while they are waiting in queues or put on hold by the call center CCEs.
    i) Any specific message requirement given by the DGGIT.
    ii) Background tune.

iii) Any information related to special campaigns of state /central governments

c. It should be suitably integrated with CRM and other communication media (phone) to send/receive data which needs to be populated on CCE screen and must also update the IVRS usage details into the CRM as the caller traverses through the IVRS and reaches the CCE.

d. A call can be placed on hold from an active state or resumed from a hold state. ACD should provide the capability of combining data with IVRS menu system that can intelligently route calls requesting further assistance: It should be able to put the caller on hold if no CCE is available and keep the caller informed about the status of the call. Also support relying on messages (as defined by DGGIT) during the hold period.

e. It should follow call routing to the CCEs with following features. It should follow at least one of the features mentioned below:

i) With 'Least Recent' - The extension that received a call the longest time ago, will be on the top of the list.

ii) With 'Fewest Calls' - The extension that received the least number of calls, will be on the top of the List

iii) Random Selection – Routing to the CCEs with first CCE picks the call, it will be closed for the other CCEs.

iv) With ‘Same CCE’ – Priority routing to the CCE who attended the call from same caller during the day or previously

f. It should allow CCEs to be members of multiple ACD groups. Each CCE should have a unique identification number.

g. When a call lands on the Service Provider’s system, the caller should be greeted with a pre-recorded welcome note in English/Punjabi language or to an available agent (as per flow approved/changed by the DGGIT) .

h. It should support voice and DTMF (touch tone shortcuts that can be used in sequence) signaling based menu service. Callers can access the information more quickly or opt to talk to CCE, without having to "drill down" through the menu structure with every call.

i. It should support Punjabi, Hindi and English Languages.

j. It should change the IVRS route based on the language selected (if required)

k. There shall be a provision of scalability of IVRS so that over a period of time it will take care of maximum functionalities of the Call Center (feasible

through IVRS) under this contract. Features of scalability shall be customizable any time during the course of the entire Project.

l. The Service Provider must have the ability to change the IVR tree, and the same shall be updated from time to time as required by the DGGIT. It must have the ability to add multiple messages on the IVR system.

m. There should be an adequate number of IVRS ports to ensure that all calls meant for CCE are able to reach the CCEs terminal.

n. There should be an option available to the caller to opt for talking to CCE by pressing a pre-defined digit any time during the IVRS announcements.

o. Caller Identification:

i. It should identify the caller (new - with phone number and existing caller with name and phone number) through CLI (Caller Line Identification)/ANI (Automatic Number Integration)/DNIS (Dialed Number identification sequence) and pass on relevant information to the screen pop up at CCE's desktop by seamlessly integrating with the ACD / CLI.

ii. For new callers, the screen pops up at CCE's desktop with only its mobile/phone number.

iii. For existing callers (present in PGRS database), the screen pop up at CCE's desktop with mobile/phone number, name should also be an option. For the existing caller, the CCE should greet him with his name.

p. It should retrieve CCE availability from Automatic Call Distribution and announce to the caller the expected wait time to talk to an available CCE.

q. It should support audio-text for playback of music, regulations, procedures, social messages as per the IVRS Call Flow & Call Tree. (Shall be decided by DGGIT during the implementation).

r. The caller can be given the option to wait in the queue or request a callback.

s. It should have the ability to add multiple awareness messages on the IVR system.

t. Facility to customize and schedule prompts during welcome message, Call on Hold etc. to promote various campaigns/Govt. scheme/Hon'ble Chief Minister's recorded messages.

5.2.19. **Call Recording solution**

a. The call center solution should have an in-built call recording solution to have 100% call recording to replay and monitor all calls. The system should record voice conversation between CCE and Citizen. The recordings should be

stored for a minimum period of three months from the date of the respective call. The Service Provider shall on a regular basis hand over the recordings to the Client as per the agreed schedule or as and when requested by DGGIT. Additionally, before exiting the contract, the Service Provider shall ensure that all call recordings are handed over to the Client.

b. The recording solution should log at least the following information: date, time, call duration, CCE ID, caller name/number, Service Request number, number dialed for outbound calls, inbound/outbound identifier (System Generated) etc.
c. It should also have the ability to provide extensive filters which helps managers / DGGIT to listen/ download voice recordings as single or bulk.
d. Inbound/Outbound Identifier - System Generated.
e. Provision of 3-way Calling and Call Recording (100%), Call Pulling, Live Call Coaching/ Call whisper.
f. The CCE ID and call record should be linked to the recorded query. The recorded query can be viewed & listened to by CCE but cannot be modified.
g. The system should also record the inbound/outbound communication of CCE and the caller at the time of providing answer and information to the citizens queries and should be supported for filtering, retrieval & playback on the basis of following: date, time, call duration, unique id, caller name, caller number, Service Request number, etc.
h. Any call rejection status and reason shall be recorded for retrieval and audit. Metadata of the call such as caller number (inbound), called number (outbound), timestamp etc. shall also be recorded.
i. The recording solution shall have the feature to playback/listen to recorded calls on the integrated PGRS accounts / any other system in online mode by the DGGIT other than the call center premises.
j. Recording Announcement: The system must play a pre-recorded announcement at the beginning of every call to inform the citizen that the call is being recorded for quality and training purposes.

5.2.20. **CRM (Customer Relationship Management) Software**

a. Features of CRM
   i. Customer Service and Care
   ii. Contact Management
   iii. Customization and integration
   iv. Graphical User Presentation

v. Inbound/Outbound
vi. CTI features
vii. Web enabled
viii. Help Desk Applications
ix. Follow-up data callbacks
x. Call history
xi. System and CCEs monitoring
xii. Data import/export
xiii. Complaint tracking system
xiv. Email Support

b. The CRM should integrate with email, voice, and other systems to facilitate task assignment and tracking. It should be able to link emails, voice recordings, and communication transcripts to specific tasks within the CRM.
c. The CRM of the call center shall be the front-end application, which shall be tightly integrated with the Public Grievance Redressal System (PGRS) application for the Punjab Government (in case of handling inbound calls if required by the client)
d. The IVR system shall be designed to be configurable, allowing the DGGIT to manage and modify the prompts as needed. This shall be done through a user-friendly interface provided by the CRM.
e. The application should be able to pick relevant data and/or screens without delay, from these systems.
f. The Service Provider shall ensure proper connectivity required to each of these servers for uninterrupted & fast servicing of all requests. Also, estimation regarding throughput required based on the rate of data flow within the network shall be done & appropriate equipment provided for.
g. The CRM shall properly handle all means of connectivity & accessibility to ensure smooth & prompt call center functioning.
h. The CRM shall have provision/feature to mark/tag any call recording as evidence which should not be deleted from the system
i. Basic information about every caller should be recorded and stored in a database in real time through the call center solution by CCE.
j. Every interaction with the customer, irrespective of the medium used by the customer should form a part of the customer interaction history. All interactions specific to a trouble ticket will have to be threaded to ensure that the response to the customer by the CCE is provided after factoring in the previous interactions.

k. The CRM shall display the previous interaction history along with remarks, action taken, escalation, medium of communication etc.. The same should be available as a downloadable report also.

l. The system should be able to maintain a log of all outgoing and incoming calls/email etc., along with the results generated by the call. It should also provide statistics on all CCEs that can be used for productivity & performance rating.

m. The system should record the ID of the CCE(s) who answered the specific Citizen's Call/Email etc.

n. CRM should automatically locate and display the incoming caller's information as the call is assigned to the next available CCE. This information could be residing in the call center database or in the other application servers. CRM should provide useful information about a customer's previous interactions. Also, customer profiles should be built & updated continuously on the basis of interactions / transactions.

o. There should be a unique internal running serial number for every ticket generated and this should be maintained without resetting the counter

5.2.21. **Non-IT Infrastructure**

a. The call center shall have following amenities but not limited to:
   i. Air ventilated, proper lightning office space with all required office furniture and power outlets
   ii. High-speed Internet and Wi-Fi
   iii. Drinking water facilities
   iv. Separate toilets for males and females.
   v. Cleanliness and hygiene of premises.
   vi. 24*7 power backup
   vii. Security
   viii. Sound-proofing to be done as appropriate like carpet on floor and walls, etc.
   ix. Other essential amenities to facilitate proper working conditions.

b. The Service Provider shall be responsible for operations and maintenance of all physical infrastructure of the call center throughout the contract period.

c. The facility of the State Helpline call center shall have adequate physical security and surveillance to restrict access of unauthorized personnel in the premises.

d. The Service Provider shall set up the workstations of the CCEs as per industry standards with minimum measurement of 3.5 ft width and 2.0 ft depth each.
e. The Service Provider shall provide LEDs (min 65 inch) at locations as under:
    i. One LED for Meeting cum training room for training of new CCEs and meetings as per requirement.
    ii. One LED per 50 seats - On the calling floor for displaying various aspects like important information, the performance matrix (like total logins, on call, on queue, on wrap up, important information) of the call center like call received, call in waiting, total active calls etc. The information to be displayed on this LED may be changed as per requirement of DGGIT.
f. The Service Provider shall allocate and maintain a dedicated room within its call center premises for the client's authorized representatives during site visits for monitoring, inspection, and review of the call center operations. The room shall be equipped with appropriate seating, internet connectivity, power supply, and necessary monitoring tools (such as access to live dashboards, call recordings, and performance reports) to facilitate effective supervision. The dedicated room shall be available for use by the Client's representatives as and when required, at no extra cost to the client.
g. The Service Provider shall maintain proper hygiene and cleanliness in the complete area of the call center premises including but not limited to entire furniture, partitions, wooden cabin walls, railings, doors, windows venetian blinds, racks, sofas, printers, computers, telephones, curtains, wall mounted fans, Air conditioner, etc. and follow government related guidelines including first-aid facility in the call center premise. Additionally, the Service Provider shall ensure regular pest control and fumigation in the premises to prevent infestations of insects, rodents, and other pests, thereby maintaining a hygienic and disease-free environment.
h. The Service Provider shall ensure a separate and non-disturbing pantry/canteen area.
i. The Service Provider shall ensure to have proper Air-conditioning to maintain adequate temperature in all the operating premises for this call center i.e., CCE floor, conference room cum training room, officer room etc.
j. The Service Provider must ensure the call center setup uses soundproof room/floor/cubicles in order to eliminate noise, echo and other agent's conversation. The noise level on the call center floor must adhere to industry

standards and should not exceed 50 decibels (dB) to ensure a conducive working environment for CCEs and clear communication with the callers. The service provider shall install a device for measuring the noise level and shall be displayed on the central monitor of the working area.

k. The Service Provider shall be solely responsible for ensuring that the call center premises comply with all applicable safety regulations and shall obtain and maintain valid certificates from the respective Government authorities. These shall include, but are not limited to, structural safety, electrical safety, fire safety (No Objection Certificate), elevator/lift safety (if applicable), building occupancy/completion, health and sanitation, environmental clearance (if applicable), and any other statutory safety or compliance certifications mandated by local, State, or Central Government authorities. Prior to the commencement of call centre operations, all required certificates and or NOC shall be obtained and submitted to the Client. Thereafter, the Service Provider shall ensure that these certificates remain valid throughout the contract period and shall renew them within the prescribed timelines or obtain fresh certificates where renewal is not applicable. Updated copies shall be submitted to the Client promptly.

l. The professional ambience of the call center should be maintained through well-painted walls and a conducive work environment, ensuring a positive and efficient workspace in the office.

m. The Service Provider shall ensure smartly covered windows with blinds and / or filmed / tinted.

n. In case of multiple projects running in the same building, the Service Provider shall ensure that there must be a separate walled area with restricted access for this contract.

o. The Service Provider shall ensure to have ISO 9001 for the location where the Call Center under this contract will be run. In case of a new location being set-up, the Service Provider needs to ensure to obtain the certificate within 90 days of signing of contract and shall ensure the validity of such certificate during the contract period.

5.3. Operations of State Helpline

5.3.1. The Service Provider shall provide CCE(s) who shall be deputed in numbers as per shift rosters finalized in consultation with DGGIT.

5.3.2. Review meetings shall be conducted as per the requirement of the DGGIT.

5.3.3. The call center operations shall comprise the following from day 1:

a. Outbound calls
b. Email support – email account shall be decided by the DGGIT
c. IVRS or any other medium as decided by DGGIT
d. Inbound calls (if required by the client at a later stage)

5.3.4. The Service Provider will work with various stakeholders of the State Helpline as per directions from DGGIT.

5.3.5. The Service Provider shall ensure to take over all the operations and any other exit related formalities as informed by DGGIT from existing call center vendors.

5.3.6. The Service Provider shall be responsible for replying to inbound emails received on a dedicated email account (to be decided by the DGGIT). Emails shall only be answered in English/Punjabi, as per the language chosen by the citizen in the email. CRM should have a facility to migrate/transmit such email on the case logs by the CCE in PGRS along with the details of complaint.

5.3.7. The Service Provider should add/ change/ remove scripts/ prompts and publish within 24 hours in the IVRS without impacting the services, with no additional cost to DGGIT. The timeline may be extended by DGGIT on receiving written justification.

5.3.8. The State Helpline call center shall have adequate redundancy options like manpower, physical and ICT infrastructure for smooth operation of the call center.

5.3.9. The Service Provider shall provide the facility of call listening / barging from remote location to DGGIT for quality assurance and audit.

5.3.10. The system should have the below listed functionalities for monitoring and other floor management aspects:

a. Whisper with the CCE without alerting the citizen.fire
b. Conference with CCE and citizens.
c. Force logout of CCE from his/her login session.
d. Ability to initiate internal chat to supervisors or other users in the system during the call.
e. Total CCE Login

5.3.11. The Service Provider shall work jointly with the DGGIT to identify problems and queries. The Service Provider shall be responsible for creating, maintaining and updating the knowledge repository.

5.3.12. The Service Provider shall work closely with DGGIT and develop workflow, escalation procedures and reporting mechanism for resolution of queries/grievances through different resolvers.

5.3.13. The Service Provider shall deploy AI-based tools capable of analyzing historical and ongoing call data to automatically generate and update a dynamic Frequently Asked Questions (FAQ) repository. These AI tools shall identify recurring queries and provide suggested responses in real-time, thereby improving the efficiency and ease of use for Call Center Executives (CCEs). The system shall continuously learn and adapt to enhance user experience, reduce resolution time, and ensure consistent information delivery across customer interactions.

5.3.14. **Operating Hours & Number of CCE seats** – The State Helpline shall be operational 09:00 AM to 07:00 PM initially which may be extended as per the requirement of the Client.

5.3.15. The Service Provider shall cooperate with DGGIT in case of unforeseen circumstances and shall work under the guidance & instructions of DGGIT. The call center operations may be changed (partially / fully) to cater the scenarios/issues or as per requirement. For instance, the call center was utilized to tackle the Covid- 19 pandemic situation and acted as "Command & Control Center " for the State. No extra cost for the same amount of manpower under the contract or for any additional facility shall be provided by DGGIT in such circumstances.

5.3.16. **Inbound Calling (if required by client)**

a. The call Center shall facilitate the citizen through inbound calls on short code/ long code provided by DGGIT for registration of grievance, demand & suggestion on PGRS, along with the information dissemination related to various government schemes for citizens.
b. In case the inbound calling is required, then the helpline shall be operational 24x7 with manpower deployed in shifts.
c. The Service Provider shall integrate the Call Center solution with Public Grievance Redressal System (PGRS) so that the data of complaints (including but not limited to citizen data, nature of complaint, timestamps, complaint title & description, and any flags etc.) captured by the CCE(s) from the call center solution are registered in PGRS. The exchange of data should happen in real-time and any response from PGRS shall be linked/stored with the appropriate ticket in the call center solution.
d. The grievances, demands and suggestions received from citizens through calls shall be captured on the CRM and also stored on the PGRS database through tight integration. A unique ticket shall be raised in CRM for every

registration and in inquiry on inbound. For grievances shared on PGRS, the unique grievance ID generated by PGRS shall be captured in CRM and communicated to citizen for status tracking

e. All inbound calls wherein the grievance / demand or suggestion shall be registered on PGRS, to be tagged with the registered reference as “registration call’ for listening to the concerned official and all stakeholders.
f. The call center shall provide the current status of registered complaint/grievance by fetching the same from PGRS.
g. The CCE should have the facility to forward the call to another Call Center/Support Desk/IVRS/person as per requirement of the process and confirmation by the DGGIT. For instance, in one of the scenarios, when a citizen calls in to avail a Door Step Delivery of a notified service offered by the Government of Punjab or their representatives, the agent must be able to forward the call to the relevant call center / support desk (external or internal) while the CCE may or may not be required to remain on the call-in conference mode, as decided and required by the DGGIT.

5.3.17. **Outbound Calling**

a. Service Provider shall undertake outbound calling activities pertaining to any government department only upon receipt of a formal authorization from the DGGIT. No outbound calling shall be initiated unless explicitly approved by DGGIT in writing, specifying brief details and tentative duration of the campaign. Requests from other departments shall not be acted upon directly by the Service Provider without such approval.
b. The CCE of the Service Provider shall call the citizens for feedback and for various purposes as required by the DGGIT.
c. Should have a facility for citizen feedback calls - automatic IVR calls from the number and short/long code provided by the DGGIT for feedback from the caller. In case of a negative response (threshold should be customizable), the call can immediately be connected to a CCE.
d. Creating awareness about the various government schemes and programs and under multiple campaigns run by different departments.
e. The Service Provider will design the outbound call flow according to the requirements of the DGGIT.
f. The inbound call where the caller is on wait by IVRS/ACD to connect with CCE for more than 60 seconds and abandoned continually twice in the same day, CCE call back shall be done to the caller within 8 hours.

g. The call center service provider shall make outbound calls to citizens regarding various State Government schemes as directed by the Client. The Client or the concerned government department shall provide the relevant scheme-related data and information, based on which the service provider shall draft the call script and obtain approval of the call script from DGGIT or the respective department, as applicable, before execution.
h. The calling schedule of outbound calls shall be defined and updated by DGGIT as required.
i. Calls should be filtered to eliminate no answer, line busy, answering machine and other non-productive calls.
j. Customers should be assigned follow-up dates and times, and the CCE should be able to create a queue of customers to be serviced or contacted during the day.
k. The system should support both single and dual call log solutions.

5.3.18. **Manpower management**

a. The DGGIT shall decide the number of man shifts per day, which can accordingly be increased/decreased based on the call volume.
b. DGGIT may request an increase/decrease of man shifts per day, based on call volumes. The Service Provider must decrease the requested number of man shifts per day within 30 days of intimation and increase the requested number of man shifts per day within 15 days of intimation. The increase in man shifts per day shall be in multiples of 50 only.
c. The CCE(s) shall be proficient with Punjabi and shall be efficient in handling calls in Hindi and English languages.
d. Before hiring a new CCE, the service operator shall ensure that the candidate's speaking and listening skills are evaluated using AI tools. The assessment results shall be shared with the Client.
e. The service provider will be responsible for management of manpower deployed in the call center and ensuring smooth operations 7 days a week.
f. Resolution of grievances of the deployed manpower shall be the sole responsibility of the Service Provider.
g. The Service Provider shall ensure and indemnify that the CCE(s) hired by the Service Provider shall not mis-conduct with the citizen/any caller (by any means) reaching out to the Government of Punjab through this call center.

h. The manpower engaged under the contract must be on the rolls of the Service Provider.
i. The Service Provider shall be required to adhere to statutory requirements as per the labor laws and abide by the Minimum Wages Act and other related laws, failing which, the DGGIT shall take appropriate action against the service provider.
j. The Service Provider shall adhere to the EPF and ESIC regulations with amendments (if any) for manpower during the entire contract period. The service provider shall submit valid proof of payment of EPF and ESIC contributions, in the form of certificates or challans issued by the respective statutory authorities, to the DGGIT on a monthly basis.
k. The service provider shall ensure that all manpower resources employed for the project, including but not limited to customer care executives (CCE), Project Managers, Team Leaders cum Trainers,, and any other personnel, sign a Non-Disclosure Agreement (NDA) before commencing their duties. The NDA shall obligate employees to maintain the confidentiality of all sensitive information, including citizen data, call records, internal processes, reports, and any other proprietary or confidential information accessed during their tenure. The Service Provider shall be responsible for enforcing compliance with the NDA and shall take appropriate action in case of any breach. The Service Provider shall provide copies of signed NDAs to the Client (DGGIT).
l. The Service Provider shall provide an identity card to the persons engaged for the work.
m. All call center personnel shall be onboarded onto the DGGIT's M-Sewa mobile application for attendance marking. The attendance data shall be shared with DGGIT at the end of each calendar month or as requested by DGGIT.
n. The Service Provider shall ensure that CCEs and other staff do not use personal mobile phones on the operations floor.
o. Compliance with labour laws regarding the daily/ weekly/ monthly man-hours/ man-days should be observed by the Service provider and all statutory liability shall lie on him in this respect.
p. The DGGIT has the right to evaluate any official of the call center team deployed for the project at any stage and can reject them in case they are not found suitable. In such cases, the DGGIT will send a written communication to the Service Provider and/or their representative. Under such

circumstances, the bidder shall replace the resource within 1 week from the date of written intimation from the DGGIT. In case a resource is replaced, the bidder will ensure that the replaced resource should be as per the qualification / experience criteria specified in the tender and necessary handover/ knowledge transfer and training has been provided to the resource being taken as the replacement.

q. The CCEs shall be required to undergo typing speed test as part of the hiring process of Service Provider. This typing speed test shall be conducted by the Service Provider for new manpower hiring on continual basis. The minimum typing speed shall be 20 words per minute (WPM) with minimum 90% accuracy in both English and Punjabi for CCEs. The test results of the CCEs may be randomly evaluated / verified by DGGIT at any point in time.

r. The Service Provider should ensure that CCE deputed for this process must have basic knowledge of geography of Punjab and should possess required communication and soft skills to cater requirement of this process.

s. In addition to CCEs, the call center team of the Service Provider shall also comprise Team Lead(s) cum Trainer(s) and Project Manager (single point of contact for the DGGIT) deployed onsite in the call center without any additional cost to the DGGIT. In the event of the replacement or resignation of the Project Manager, he/she shall be required to serve a mandatory notice period of one (1) month. During this period, comprehensive knowledge transfer and proper handover must be carried out to the full satisfaction of the Client. Under no circumstances shall the Project Manager be relieved of their responsibilities without completion of the notice period and prior written approval from the Client.

t. The Service Provider shall be responsible for manpower deployment on both inbound and outbound processes (voice, email etc.), as per live scenarios, call flow trend or as directed by the DGGIT.

u. The Service Providers are required to put in a Man-hour login (MHL) web-based monitoring system, so that DGGIT is able to verify and monitor daily work activity done by the team on the project. The Service Provider should submit a MHL report to the DGGIT as and when requested. In addition, the admin level access of the system must be given to The DGGIT, which should have a provision to check such reports and dashboards on a real time basis.

v. The desired qualifications of manpower for the call center shall be as per below:

SN	Role	Qualifications and Experience
1.	CCE	a. 10 + 2 with a minimum of 3 years of experience as a CCE or Graduation with one year experience as a CCE b. Must have basic computer operating knowledge. c. The minimum typing speed shall be 20 Words Per Minute (WPM) with a minimum of 90% accuracy in both English and Punjabi.
2.	Project Manager (1)	a. MBA b. Minimum 10 years of call center experience, out of which minimum 5 years experience as Manager (in call center operations)
3.	Manager (1 as per 200 CCEs)	Minimum 7 years of call center experience, out of which minimum 3 years experience as Team Lead (in call center operations)
4.	Team Leads cum Trainers (1 per 25 CCEs)	a. Graduate b. Minimum 5 years experience as CCE.

5.3.19. **Trainings of Call Center Staff**

a. The Service Provider shall conduct a test of the newly hired CCEs post completion of 3 days training, and only candidates who pass shall be put on floor to take live citizen calls. The compliance report shall be submitted to DGGIT in this regard as and when so requested. DGGIT may involve its own staff during the training and evaluation process.

b. The Service Provider shall provide adequate and regular training to call center executives (CCEs) deployed at the State Helpline call center.

c. The Call Center trainers shall be trained regarding Government services related issues & schemes by the DGGIT. The call center trainers shall further provide these trainings to the CCEs on a regular basis.

d. Training topics should include but not limited to training on handling various types of expected calls, CRM platform and other software/hardware to be used by CCEs, soft skills and dialect training.
e. Training process shall include training for new hires and refresher training for all CCEs. In addition, training will be conducted for all CCEs on changes in schemes suggested by DGGIT.
f. The Service Provider shall build an FAQ database / knowledge bank in coordination with the DGGIT and various departments concerned. The Service Provider shall also create a step-by-step workflow for the call center team to effectively handle day-to-day operations and any special cases.

5.3.20. **Language Capabilities**

a. The CCE should be proficient in communicating in all the three languages i.e., Punjabi, English and Hindi so that citizen interaction can be done efficiently and cases can be logged for proper issue resolution.
b. For all inbound calls, an IVRS prompt may provide language options to the caller to facilitate language selection. The Service Provider should ensure that an adequate number of CCEs trained in Punjabi language are available for providing services
c. Default language for calls (both inbound and outbound) shall be Punjabi when the preferred language of the caller is not known. However, in case of outbound calls, the CCE may also ask for the preferred language of the citizen at the beginning of the call. In case of a repeat caller, the language of preference from last time will be used.
d. Outbound emails to customers shall be in the language of communication received from the citizen.

5.3.21. **Quality Assurance Process**

a. The Service Provider shall ensure the quality of the call and resolution provided by the CCE for the entire duration of the contract. The quality assurance includes the following, but not limited to:
    i. Monitoring at least 2% of calls/emails etc. of all the CCEs on a daily basis.
    ii. Monitoring the performance of CCEs on the basis of quality templates to be prepared by the call center service provider and approved by the DGGIT.

iii. The Service Provider shall deploy and maintain an AI-based evaluation mechanism as part of the call center quality monitoring system. The AI system must assist in the automated assessment of agent performance, sentiment analysis, call categorization, and compliance tracking across all calls. The AI engine must be integrated with the CRM/Call Center software and be accessible to DGGIT officials for monitoring, reporting, and performance review. AI shall also provide customized guidance to CCEs to improve their performance. The CCEs who are unable to improve their performance shall be replaced promptly.

b. The Client may engage a Third-Party Auditor (TPA) for independent auditing, SLA breaches and quality assessment of call center operations, including monitoring of outbound and inbound calls handled by the service provider.

c. The TPA shall evaluate call quality, adherence to scripts, response time, resolution quality, and customer experience. A defined percentage of the total annual call volume shall be audited across randomly selected samples, ensuring representation across shifts, agents, and call types.

d. The Service Provider shall provide access to call recordings, CCE logs, CRM records, and any other data required by the TPA for conducting the audit. The findings of the TPA shall be binding for performance evaluation and SLA compliance.

e. Enhancing the existing training modules, frequently asked questions, etc., that help improve call center operations

5.3.22. The service provider shall ensure that no emails should be deleted from the email platform during the contract period.

5.4. Content and SoP preparation (for inbound calling if required)

5.4.1. **Content Creation:** Content creation refers to the conversion and transformation of the identified information and data in predefined formats.

a. It will be the responsibility of the Service Provider to develop the initial standard knowledge /question bank in consultation with various departments. The question bank developed by the bidder shall be validated by the DGGIT before the rollout. The Service Provider will ensure that validated and updated information is available within the system for answering the FAQs.

b. Once the data transfer is completed by DGGIT, this data shall be processed at State Helpline level for conversion in predefined formats, usually in script

form, which shall be utilized by CCEs during service delivery to citizens. During data processing, it shall be ensured by the Service Provider that sanctity of data is maintained and no change in data content is done.

c. The Service Provider will provide the complete manual / SoP for the process before go-live and periodically during the tenure of the contract.

d. In addition, the Service Provider will prepare and maintain various manuals as per the requirements of the DGGIT which are relevant for the operations of Call Center. This will help the call center team to share proper information with the citizens by looking at the respective manuals.

5.4.2. **Content Creation: Content Update and Modification:**

a. The Service Provider shall also ensure that the knowledge repository is reviewed on regular-basis in consultation with the departments and the DGGIT, and is updated after the validation by the DGGIT

b. Any update request by DGGIT must be incorporated within 2 days of such intimation. The Service Provider must also ensure preparation of FAQs on the basis of frequent service requests experienced at the Call Center.

c. The Service Provider will create, maintain, update and validate the scripts from the data for the purposes of facilitating the same to its CCEs. These scripts shall be considered for real-time citizen interaction usage only after approval from DGGIT.

5.4.3. **Content Validation:** The Service Provider must ensure validation and formal vetting / approval of scripts (including FAQs) generated and updated on the basis of content received from the DGGIT or the concerned govt. department, before its use for real-time citizen interaction.

5.5. Call Center Escalation Matrix

5.5.1. The Service Provider shall provide the escalation matrix of at least 2 levels, each representing a different tier of support within the call center.

5.5.2. Level 1 - CCE (Call center Executive): He/she is responsible to handle initial customer inquiries, provide basic support, and attempt to resolve issues at the first point of contact.

5.5.3. Level 2 - First Level of Escalation (Trainer cum Team Lead): He/she is responsible to handle more complex issues that require in-depth knowledge and expertise beyond what Level 1 CCEs can provide and/or CCEs have been unable to satisfactorily assist the citizen.

5.5.4. Level 3 - Second Level of Escalation (Call Center Project Manager): He/she is responsible to address highly technical or specialized issues that cannot be resolved by Level 2 support.

5.6. Analytics, Dashboards & Reporting

5.6.1. The State Helpline Solution shall be equipped with extensive reporting capabilities to generate various reports based on DGGIT requirements.

5.6.2. The user interface for reporting tools shall be online, GUI-based, and accessible securely from any location without the need for a VPN. The system shall implement robust encryption protocols (such as HTTPS/SSL) and secure authentication mechanisms to ensure data confidentiality and integrity during access and transmission.

5.6.3. Reporting tools shall be pluggable to any department portal via API integration. Any further reporting required shall be duly informed during the operational phase of the project.

5.6.4. The data analytics tools and dashboards have to be powered by advanced tools as deemed appropriate in-sync with the Departments databases.

5.6.5. Data analytics should (but not limited to) generate reports based on functional requirements of the project.

5.6.6. The dashboards shall provide real-time insights across all channels in a single report in addition to detailed reports for each channel.

5.6.7. The Service Provider shall ensure availability of proper reports and data analysis to optimally utilize the call center manpower in different processes. Additionally, analysis of common reports such as ATA, AHT etc. shall be available

5.6.8. The Service Provider is required to build/modify/automate/maintain the required MIS/Dashboard as directed by DGGIT from time to time, within the call center CRM and integrate it with Department Portals or any other Dashboards.

5.6.9. Suitable reporting software should be available to generate standard report formats to measure/ verify various SLAs, for monitoring the performance of CCEs, IVRS, ACD etc. The Service Provider shall automate the SLA monitoring process to the extent possible and shall leverage existing applications and/or develop a new portal or dashboard for automated report generation and sharing. The key characteristics of the reports shall include:

a. The reports should be in flexible report formats, in pdf, excel, txt or any other user-friendly structure including graphics depending on the request of the DGGIT from time to time.

b. Reports should also be available in **web-enabled format with live access** to DGGIT & should be configurable to be mailed to a defined mailing list at defined interval/ period.

5.6.10. Indicative list of parameters for reports generated by MIS should include but not limited to:

a. Type of complaints/grievances
b. Department wise
c. Division/ District /Block/ Tehsil/ Thana/ Ward wise and other last entities report
d. Repeat requests / complaints

5.6.11. It should generate different types of reports on user interactions (through IVR, email etc.) such as but not limited to:

a. Total number of calls - Inbound and Outbound
b. Number of calls diverted to CCEs from IVR
c. It should generate call center queue analysis reports including but not limited to:
   i. Number of calls waiting in queue.
   ii. Average call duration.
   iii. Average call waiting time
   iv. Abandoned calls
   v. Number of outbound calls (Feedback on PGRS, calling citizens regarding Government schemes).

5.6.12. It should generate CCE reports (Summary for all CCEs and details for each CCE): Login and logout, average speed of answer time, average talk time, MIS related to average handling time, average hold time, average wrap up time, number of dropped calls before pickup, number of dropped calls after pickup, idle time, performance reports, number of emails received, number of call backs report, no answer, etc.

5.6.13. It should also be capable of generating customized reports/ MIS including graphical reports as per DGGIT's requirement.

5.6.14. Standard reports (like IVRS, ACD etc.) should be generated on hourly, daily, weekly, monthly, quarterly, half yearly and yearly basis.

5.6.15. It should be integrated with the PGRS / State Helpline database & portal which shall provide access to DGGIT for report generation.

5.7. Monitoring

5.7.1. A facility should be available for the DGGIT monitoring team, external & internal auditors to periodically inspect the functioning of the Call Center. The monitoring team should be able to access all sub- systems/ servers, records, security measures including data & software back-ups, firewalls, anti-virus software updates etc.

5.7.2. The Service Provider has to ensure that whenever members of the DGGIT are available in the call center for inspection, they should have the option to check the real time internal reports and can have the option to barge in between the calls.

5.7.3. DGGIT may audit at any time the live/recorded calls and/or using playback feature or remote call barging facility. The Service Provider shall make sure to provide such access for monitoring, audit and quality assurance purposes through some online login.

5.7.4. The Service Provider shall install and maintain High-Definition (HD) CCTV cameras to ensure complete coverage of all areas of the call center premises, including but not limited to entry and exit points, workstations, common areas, and server/communication rooms. The CCTV system shall be operational 24x7 with a minimum recording retention period of 30 days. Access to live and recorded footage shall be provided to the Client or its authorized representatives as and when required.

5.8. Contract Period

5.8.1. This contract shall be valid for a period of two years from the date of signing, and may be extended for an additional one year based on the satisfactory performance of the service provider, on the same terms and conditions, at the sole discretion of DGGIT.

5.9. Exit Management

5.9.1. The duration of exit management period will normally be 1 month from date of termination or 1 month prior to expiry of contract / work order. In case, during Exit Management, the services are provided by the Service Provider, post termination or expiry of the work order, the payment for such services provided shall be made by DGGIT as per the same terms and conditions of the Contract

5.9.2. During the exit management period and till the DGGIT issues a written sign-off, the Service Provider will not take action to stop the work. In addition, during such a period, the Service Provider will permit the DGGIT or its nominated agency to assess the existing services being delivered.

5.9.3. During the exit management period, the Service Provider shall ensure proper support as per the contract so that the business of the DGGIT is not affected.

5.9.4. The Service Provider shall provide all such information as may reasonably be necessary for a smooth handover to DGGIT / replacement agency and which the Service Provider has in its possession or control at any time during the exit, all information (including but not limited to documents, records, database, etc) in digital and/ or paper form relating to the services reasonably necessary to enable DGGIT and its nominated agencies to carry out due diligence in order to transition the provision of the Services to DGGIT or its nominated agencies.

5.9.5. The DGGIT will issue a written sign-off after the transition / take-over from the Service Provider. The Service Provider shall not remove/delete/destroy any data/content/information/communication/ report etc. till such a written signoff is provided by the DGGIT along with an explicit request to delete/ remove/destroy the content.

5.9.6. The payment of the last invoice as per the payment terms mentioned in this tender will be paid only on the written sign-off from the DGGIT.

5.9.7. The Service Provider will also have to handover the complete database for the CRM software and any media or other electronic or physical data generated (like call records, call logs, case logs, email logs/details, Call Disposition details etc. generated during the contract period) or created during the tenure of the contract (or received as handover from previous vendor), as that will be the Intellectual Property Rights of the DGGIT.

5.10. Outsourcing / subletting

5.10.1. No part of the contract shall be outsourced by the Service Provider. In case, the Service Provider has to take help from any third party such as software development etc, the Service Provider must take the approval from DGGIT.

6. SLA and Penalties

6.1.1. The penalties with regards to the delay is mentioned below

SN	Activity	Target/Service level	Penalty for delays beyond target level
1.	Submission of fixed and variable PBG	15 days from the issue of LoI / request for increase of CCEs	Rs. 200 per day for a delay of the first 5 days. Rs. 500 per day for delay after first 5 days
2.	Signing of contract	15 days from the issue of LoI	Rs. 200 per day for a delay of the first 5 days. Rs. 500 per day for delay after first 5 days
3.	Go-Live including deployment of complete manpower and CCEs, CRM customization, deployment & integration (if required), hardware & software deployment, etc.	200 man-shifts per day within 15 days and the remaining man-shifts per day within 30 days from signing of the contract	Rs. 2,000 per day
4.	ISO 9001 certificate for the call center that is setup under this contract	90 days from Go-live	Rs. 1,000 per day
5.	Average Call Response Time - average time for a caller waiting in a queue to be attended by an agent	95% of incoming calls within 10 seconds	0.5% of the monthly invoice value for every % drop or part thereof below the target calculated on a pro-rata basis.
6.	Abandoned Call Rate - % of calls where the call patched on Call Center IVR/dialer or caller requested for agent however call got disconnected before being answered by the Agent or caller disconnected while waiting for the agent to answer the call	Less than 1 %	1% of monthly invoice value for every % increase or part thereof above the target calculated on a pro-rata basis

SN	Activity	Target/Service level	Penalty for delays beyond target level
7.	Time taken for updating IVRS Functionality, Email content, other IT/Software	Within 24 hours of intimation by DGGIT	Rs. 1,000 per delay of 24 hrs or part thereof
8.	Request for information, data, reports in desired format by DGGIT. Also any change in report format in the software	Within 24 hours of intimation by DGGIT	Rs. 1,000 per day or part thereof
9.	Functionalities for monitoring, Reporting, CCTV access and other floor management aspects from remote location to DGGIT. ● Call listening/Barging facility as mentioned in this document ● CRM features for monitoring as mentioned in this document ● Unable to download the reports as mentioned in this document ● CCTV access	The facility should be in proper working condition at all times and as specified in the contract	Rs. 5,000 per instance
10.	Maintenance of Call Center - IT infrastructure like desktops, headsets, etc.	IT infrastructure should be in proper working condition at all times and as per specification in the contract	Rs. 1,000 per instance per device
11.	Maintenance of Call Center - Non - IT infrastructure like civil, electrical, furniture, ACs, etc.	Rectification of issues reported by DGGIT within 5 days of intimation	Rs. 1,000 per instance per issue
12.	Manpower deployment - CCEs / Trainer / Team lead / Project Manager	100% as per LoI / contract / subsequent increase or decrease request at all times	Rs. 300 per day per CCE Rs. 2,000 per day per Trainer cum Team Lead / Project Manager

SN	Activity	Target/Service level	Penalty for delays beyond target level
			Additionally, the billing for absent / non-deployed days shall not be made.
13.	Manpower deployed must be on the rolls of Service Provider	At all time	Rs 5,000 per instance per resource (applicable maximum once per month per resource)
14.	Manpower Replacement on request by DGGIT	Staff, other than the Project Manager, shall be deployed within one week of intimation. The Project Manager shall be deployed within one month of the intimation	Rs 1,000 per day per CCE Rs 2,000 per day per Team Lead cum Trainer Rs 3,000 per day for Project Manager
15.	Deployed resources must have requisite qualifications and experience	As mentioned in this document	Rs. 10,000 per resource per instance for CCE Rs. 50,000 per resource per instance for Team Lead cum Trainer and Project Manager, Along with immediate replacement of resource
16.	Resolution of the critical issues (as per Clause 6.1.2)	Within 2 hours of incident / intimation	Between 2 hours to 8 hours: Rs. 1,000 per hour After 8 hours: Rs. 2,000 per hour Note: For repeated issues, penalty shall be Rs. 2,000 per hour, effective immediately from time of incidence / intimation.
17.	Resolution of the non-critical issues (as per Clause 6.1.3)	Within 24 hours	Rs. 1,000 per delay of 24 hrs or part thereof
18.	Call quality score - ensure that certain standards are adhered to	95%	0.2% of monthly invoice value for every % drop or part

SN	Activity	Target/Service level	Penalty for delays beyond target level
	during the calls. A composite score will be calculated on the basis of average of quality score of 25 calls audited by DGGIT on quality score parameters (Proper opening, Issue Identification, Proper Issue Resolution, Proper closing, Proper case logging in the CRM software, quality of information provided, diction, language, politeness, ability to satisfy customers, ability to get correct information from customers, etc.) every month. As per format 9.4		thereof below the target calculated on a pro-rata basis.
19.	The agents are expected to login into the system for 8 hours per man shift excluding lunch/ tea breaks, etc	8 hours (with relaxation maximum 10 Mins)	Rs. 50 for every 15 min.
20.	Noise level within the working area	≤ 50 decibels	Rs. 5,000 per instance
21.	Maintenance of safety compliance certificates or NOCs, as per 5.2.24(k), at all times	100%	Rs. 10,000 per instance (applicable maximum once per month)
22.	Central LEDs (min 65 inch each) - one LED per 50 seats - which displays information as requested by DGGIT on calling floor	100% working at all times with correct information displayed against all parameters	Rs. 3,000 per instance for non availability of LED Rs. 1,000 per instance for incorrect information
23.	One LED Display (min 65 inch) in training cum conference room for training purposes	100% working at all times	Rs. 3,000 per instance

SN	Activity	Target/Service level	Penalty for delays beyond target level
24.	Conference Room cum Training room availability	-	Rs. 5,000 per instance (applicable maximum once per month)
25.	Hold Time - holding the call in between the conversation	2% calls with more than 30 seconds hold time	0.2% of monthly invoice value for every % increase or part thereof above the target calculated on a pro-rata basis.
26.	Increase of CCEs	Refer Clause 5.3.18(c)	Rs. 1,000 per delayed deployment per CCE per day
27.	Decrease of CCEs	Decrease of seats within 30 days of intimation.	Excess CCEs will not be billed beyond 30 days
28.	Call recording with remote access	100% - availability for three months from the respective call.	Rs. 10,000 per instance
29.	Outbound Call Performance	90% calls should be closed within the average time mutually agreed for a feedback survey (*)	0.2% of monthly invoice value for every % drop or part thereof below the target calculated on a pro-rata basis.
30.	Non-payment of minimum wages to the deployed CCEs as per Minimum Wages Act and / or as notified by Labour Department, Punjab / Deputy Commissioner concerned (Skilled Category)	As per Clause 5.3.18.i	Rs. 500 per CCE per month. Shortfall in wages to be paid to all concerned CCEs as arrears with 6% simple interest per annum.
31	Any non-compliance of the contract which is not covered above.	As mentioned in this document	Rs. 1,000 per non - compliance on the first instance A letter of warning along with penalty of Rs. 5,000/- on each repeated instance for

SN	Activity	Target/Service level	Penalty for delays beyond target level
			the same non-compliance.

**As per legacy data experience, the indicative baseline is 200 outbound calls per day per operator and 80 inbound calls per day per operator, which may be revised based on the nature of assignment and mutual agreement between DGGIT and the Service Provider and the length of the call script.*

6.1.2. "Critical Issues" means the issues which impact the operations of the Call Center such as but not limited to, software glitches, hardware failures/shortages, data breach, security breach, etc. Call center services are either partially or fully unavailable (includes partial outage/full outage).

6.1.3. "Non-Critical Issues" means the issue which does not impact the operations of the call center such as but not limited to, unsatisfactory housekeeping, failure to adhere to industry-specific regulations, training and knowledge gaps, poor customer feedback handling, etc.

6.1.4. In case, it is found that if a penalty is applicable against more than one SLA parameters, then the SLA against which the higher penalty is imposable, shall be applicable.

6.1.5. The maximum penalty shall not exceed by 20% of the monthly bill value.

6.1.6. In case any of the maximum level of penalty is breached for 3 consecutive months, an additional penalty of 10% of monthly bill value shall be applicable for subsequent months until the penalty goes below 20%. In addition to this, the DGGIT may also issue warning letter / termination of contract notice (for not running the services to the satisfaction of the DGGIT / breach of service level & quality) and may initiate forfeiture of PBG and blacklisting of the bidder.

6.1.7. The data collected / integrated by the Service Provider while running the State Helpline shall be maintained with high security. The agents shall not take away the citizen's data (personal / non-personal) outside the office. The agents cannot collect any personal information from the caller which is not related to his/her call to the State Helpline. Privacy of citizens has to be adhered under Information Technology Act, 2000 (including the amendments issued later) and other legal provisions that exist or come in future in this regard. Any breach in this regard will be the responsibility of the Service Provider. DGGIT can initiate legal action against the Service Provider in case of any breach in this regard or can forfeit PBG.

6.1.8. It may be noted that deductions shall be made for services not rendered. These deductions shall be separate from the penalties and accordingly the penalty cap shall not apply to deductions.

6.1.9. The penalty / timelines may be relaxed by DGGIT for justified reasons submitted in writing by the Service Provider.

6.1.10. There shall be no penalty till date of Go-Live except S.No. 1, 2, 3 & 21 of clause 6.1.1

7. Payment terms

7.1. General

7.1.1. The Service Provider shall submit its monthly invoice mentioning details of actual number of 8 hour man shifts done by the Service Provider and total amount of claim during the first week of every month following the month for which services have been rendered. The total number of 8 hour man shifts cannot exceed the monthly man shift work order given by the Client. DGGIT may request the Service Provider to furnish any relevant clarification/information to facilitate proper checking of the bill.

For example: The Client has placed a work order for 600 qty 8 hour man shifts per day. Then the invoice amount cannot exceed 600 * 30 = 18,000 man shifts (assuming the month has 30 days).

7.1.2. For the billing, the Service Provider shall generate invoice/bill as per following:

Sc = Monthly cost per 8-hour man shift quoted by the Service Provider

Sn = Number of 8 hour man shifts done by Service Provider in the relevant month

Sb = Cost of a single 8 hour man shift = Sc / (No. of days in the relevant month)

St = Total monthly cost of all man shifts = Sn x Sb

Note: "St" shall be calculated on pro-rata based on "Sn" depending on increase / decrease of seats as ordered by DGGIT for changes in "Sn" during the billing period

Pt = Total amount of penalties

Invoice amount = St - Pt

7.1.3. The Service Provider shall ensure to submit documents / artifacts in support of the SLAs along with monthly invoice, such as but not limited to:

a. Call center System Availability
b. Average Call Response Time
c. Abandoned Call Rate
d. IVRS Functionality, Email, other IT/Software related Updating time
e. Features/ Modules/Report Generation/workflow new/change existing
f. Manpower Deployment
g. Resolution of critical issues
h. Resolution of non-critical issues
i. Call Quality Score

j. Man hour login (MHL) report.

7.1.4. Payment will be made monthly purely on the basis of monthly cost of 8 hour man shift and no separate payment for the hardware, software, outbound calls, manpower, incidental costs, etc will be made to the Service Provider.

7.1.5. Payment to the Service Provider will be made in Indian Rupees through account payee cheque / NEFT / RTGS.

7.1.6. Payments shall be subject to deductions / penalties of any amount for which the Service Provider is liable under this tender. Further, all payments shall be made subject to deduction of TDS (Tax Deduction at Source) at the rate applicable from time to time as per The Income-Tax Act, 1961, and any other applicable deductions/ taxes.

7.1.7. All taxes, duties and any statutory levies etc. payable by the Service Provider during the contract tenure shall be the sole responsibility of the Service Provider to be paid to concerned DGGIT.

7.1.8. The decision of the DGGIT pertaining to the quality and quantity of works/services performed by the Service Provider will be final and acceptable to the Service Provider besides being binding. It shall be the responsibility of the Service Provider to rectify the deficiencies so pointed out without any extra payment.

7.1.9. The Go-Live date shall be read as day 1 and all the payments shall be considered from the date of Go-Live.

8. General Contract Conditions

8.1. Corrupt/Fraudulent Practices

8.1.1. All the bidders must observe the highest standards of ethics during the process of selection of Supplier and during the performance and execution of contract.

8.1.2. For this purpose, definitions of the terms are set forth as follows:

a. "Corrupt practice" means the offering, giving, receiving or soliciting of anything of value to influence the action of the DGGIT or its personnel in contract executions.

b. Fraudulent practice" means a misrepresentation of facts, in order to influence a selection process or the execution of a contract, and includes collusive practice among bidders (prior to or after Proposal submission) designed to establish Proposal prices at artificially high or non-competitive levels and to deprive the DGGIT of the benefits of free and open competition.

c. “Unfair trade practice” means supply of services different from what is ordered, or change in the Scope of Work.

d. “Coercive practice” means harming or threatening to harm, directly or indirectly, persons or their property to influence their participation in the selection process or execution of contract.

8.1.3. DGGIT will reject a proposal for award, if it determines that the bidder recommended for award, has been determined to have been engaged in corrupt, fraudulent or unfair trade practices.

8.1.4. DGGIT will declare a bidder ineligible, either indefinitely or for a stated period of time, for award of contract, if bidder is found to be engaged in corrupt, fraudulent and unfair trade practice in competing for, or in executing, the contract at any point of time.

8.1.5. The World Bank’s Guidelines on Preventing and Combating Fraud and Corruption in Program for Results Financing dated February 1, 2012 and revised July 10, 2015 will be applicable to this contract as provided at **Section 7.3** incorporated as a Section of the tender/proposal document) and these may also be accessed at:-
https://www.worldbank.org/en/programs/program-for-results-financing#3

8.2. Limitation of Liability

8.2.1. The liability of Service Provider(whether in contract, negligence, by statute or otherwise) for any claim in any manner related to this Agreement, including the work, deliverables or Services covered by this Agreement, shall be the payment of direct damages only which shall in no event exceed the aggregate of revenue earned by the Service Operator as on the date of the claim.

8.3. Confidentiality

8.3.1. Confidential information shall mean and include any and all confidential or proprietary information furnished, in whatever form or medium, or disclosed verbally or otherwise by the Service Provider and/ or the Client to each other including, but not limited to, the services, plans, financial data and personnel statistics, whether or not marked as confidential or proprietary by the parties.

8.3.2. The Service Provider shall ensure that while providing services, all the details and information is kept confidential.

8.3.3. During the execution of the project except with the prior written consent of the Client, the Service Provider or its personnel shall not at any time communicate to any person or entity any confidential information acquired in the course of the contract.

8.4. Intellectual Property Rights

8.4.1. The work done by the Service Provider (except third party COTS - Commercial Off the Shelf software), database backup/schema, creatives, designs, documents, etc. shall be Intellectual Property of the Client.

8.4.2. Records in the database are the exclusive property of Client and the same shall not be used/shared by Service Provider in any manner.

8.5. Termination of contract for default

8.5.1. The DGGIT, without prejudice to any other remedy for breach of contract, by written notice of default sent to the Service Provider, may terminate the contract in whole or in part by giving two months notice, if Service Provider:

a. Fails to deliver any or all of the services within the specified period in the contract, or within any extension thereof granted by the client.

b. Fails to perform any other obligation under the contract.

c. Violates code of integrity and/or engaged in fraud and corruption, in competing for or in execution of the contract.

In such a case, the provisions under the Exit Management clause shall apply.

8.6. Termination of contract for insolvency, dissolution etc.

8.6.1. The Client may at any time terminate the Contract by giving written notice to the Service Provider, if the Service Provider becomes bankrupt or otherwise insolvent or in case of dissolution of firm/company or winding up of firm/company. In this event termination will be without compensation to the Service Provider, provided that such termination will not prejudice or affect any right of action or remedy, which has accrued or will accrue thereafter to Client. In such a case, the provisions under the Exit Management clause shall apply.

8.7. Termination for convenience

8.7.1. The Client reserves the right to terminate, by prior written 1 month notice, the whole or part of the contract, at any time for its convenience. The notice of termination shall specify that termination is for Client's convenience, the extent to which performance of work under the contract is terminated, and the date upon which such termination becomes effective. In such a case, the provisions under the Exit Management clause shall apply

8.8. Force Majeure

8.8.1. The PBG of the Service Provider shall not be forfeited or the contract shall not be terminated for default if and to the extent that delays in performance or other failure to perform its obligations under the Contract is the result of an event of Force Majeure.

8.8.2. For purposes of this clause, "Force Majeure" means an event beyond the control of the Service Provider and not involving the Service Provider's fault or negligence, and not foreseeable. Such events may include, but are not restricted to, wars or revolutions, riot or commotion, earthquake, fires, floods, epidemics, and quarantine restrictions.

8.8.3. If a Force Majeure situation arises, the Service Provider shall promptly notify the Client in writing of such condition and the cause thereof. Unless otherwise directed by Client in writing, the Service Provider shall continue to perform its obligations under the contract as far as is reasonably practical, and shall seek all

reasonable alternative means for performance not prevented by the Force Majeure event.

8.9. Resolution of disputes

8.9.1. If any dispute arises between parties, then these would be resolved in following ways:

a. **Amicable Settlement:** Either party of the contract may send a written notice of dispute to the other party. The party receiving the notice of dispute will consider the Notice and respond to it in writing within 30 days after receipt. If that party fails to respond within 30 days, or the dispute cannot be amicably settled within 60 days following the response of that party, then the second Sub-clause of resolution of disputes shall become applicable.

b. **Arbitration:** In case dispute arising between the Client and the Service Provider, which has not been settled amicably, the Service Provider can request the Client to refer the dispute for Arbitration under Arbitration and Conciliation Act, 1996 and amendments thereof. Such disputes shall be referred to the Arbitrator which shall be appointed by Hon'ble Punjab and Haryana High Court. The Indian Arbitration and Conciliation Act, 1996 and any statutory modification or re-enactment thereof, shall apply to these arbitration proceedings. Arbitration proceedings will be held at Mohali. The decision of the arbitrator shall be final and binding upon both the parties. All arbitration awards shall be in writing and shall state the reasons for the award. The expenses of the arbitration as determined by the arbitrator shall be borne equally by the client and the Service Provider. However, the expenses incurred by each party in connection with the preparation, presentation and litigation shall be borne by the party itself.

8.10. Legal Jurisdiction

8.10.1. All legal disputes between the parties shall be subject to the jurisdiction of the Courts situated in Mohali, Punjab only.

8.11. Amendment to the contract

8.11.1. The contract signed thereof can be amended by mutual consent of both the parties, provided such amendment is made in writing and signed by both the parties.

9. Bid formats

[Note: Italicized comments in rectangular brackets of formats have been provided for the purpose of guidance/ instructions to bidders for the preparation of the bid formats. These should not appear in the final bids to be submitted by the bidders]

9.1. Covering letter

Bid Reference No.: DGGIT/Helpline/2025/2

[Bidders are required to submit the covering letter as given here on their letterhead]

To

The Director,
Directorate of Good Governance & Information Technology, Punjab
2nd Floor, Academic Block, MGSIPA,
Sector - 26, Chandigarh - 160019

Sub: Submission of bid for providing Setting up, Operations and Management of State Helpline

Dear Sir,

1. We, the undersigned, have carefully examined the above referenced Tender and submit our bid in full conformity with the said Tender.
2. We have read all the provisions of Tender & corrigendum and confirm that these are acceptable to us.
3. We further declare that additional conditions, deviations, if any, found in our bid shall not be given effect to.
4. We agree to abide by this bid, consisting of this letter and financial bid, and all attachments, till 90 days from the date of submission of bids as stipulated in the Tender and any additional documents submitted, and it shall remain binding upon us and may be accepted by you at any time before the expiration of that period.
5. Until the formal final contract is prepared and executed between us, this bid, together with your written acceptance of the bid and your notification of award, shall constitute a binding contract between us.
6. We hereby declare that all the information and statements made in this proposal are true and accept that any misrepresentation or misinterpretation contained in it may lead to our disqualification.

7. We understand you are not bound to accept any bid you receive, not to give reason for rejection of any bid and that you will not reimburse any expenses incurred by us in bidding.
8. We declare that this is our sole participation in this Tender bid and we are not participating / co-participating through any of the other related parties or channels.
9. We have not been blacklisted or barred by any State Govt. / Central Govt. / Board, Corporations and Government Societies / PSU for any reason as on date of bid submission.
10. Our details have been filled below: -

SN	Particulars	Details
1.	Name of the bidder	
2.	Address with telephone numbers, email, etc	
3.	Date of incorporation and/or commencement of business	
4.	Registration Number	
5.	PAN Number	
6.	GST Registration Number	
7.	Name, designation, postal address, e-mail address, phone numbers (including mobile) etc., of Authorized Signatory of the bidder with power of attorney.	
8.	Details of individuals who will serve as the point of contact/communication with the DGGIT in case of the award of the contract. *[The details must include Name, designation, postal address, e-mail address, phone numbers (including mobile) etc.]*	

11. Details of Similar Works that are in progress or have been completed (Proofs attached) :-

SN	Name of the Service Contract	Name of the DGGIT	Number of persons deployed	Value of Contract	Contract start date	Contract completion date

Signature

Full Name

In the capacity of

Duly authorized to sign Proposal for and on behalf of

Date……. Place…….

9.2. Format for Performance Bank Guarantee

The Director,
Directorate of Good Governance & Information Technology, Punjab
2nd Floor, Academic Block, MGSIPA,
Sector - 26, Chandigarh - 160019

Whereas, <<name of the Service Provider and address>> (hereinafter called “the applicant”) has undertaken, in pursuance of Tender No: **DGGIT/Helpline/2025/2** dated. <<insert date>> for Selection of Service Provider for Setting up, Operations and Management of State Helpline" to Department of Good Governance Reforms & Information Technology (hereinafter called “the beneficiary”)

And whereas it has been stipulated in the said contract that the applicant shall furnish you with a irrevocable and unconditional bank guarantee by a recognized bank for the sum specified therein as security for compliance with its obligations in accordance with the contract;

And whereas we, <<Name of the Bank>> a banking company incorporated and having its head /registered office at <<address of the registered office>> and having one of its offices at <<address of the local office>> have agreed to give the DGGIT such a bank guarantee.
Now, therefore, we hereby affirm that we are guarantors and responsible to you, on behalf of the Service Provider, upto a total of Rs. <<Insert Value>> (Rupees <<insert value in words>> only) and we undertake to pay you, upon your first written demand declaring the Service Provider to be in default under the contract and without cavil or argument, any sum or sums within the limits of Rs. <<Insert Value>> (Rupees <<insert value in words>> only) as aforesaid, without your needing to prove or to show grounds or reasons for your demand or the sum specified therein.
We hereby waive the necessity of your demanding the said debt from the applicant before presenting us with the demand.
We further agree that no change or addition to or other modification of the terms of the contract to be performed there under or of any of the contract documents which may be made between you and the Service Provider shall in any way release us from any liability under this guarantee and we hereby waive notice of any such change, addition or modification.
Notwithstanding anything contained herein:

1. Our liability under this bank guarantee shall not exceed Rs <<Insert Value>> (Rupees <<insert value in words>> only).
2. This bank guarantee shall be valid up to <<insert expiry date>>.
3. It is a condition of our liability for payment of the guaranteed amount or any part thereof arising under this bank guarantee that we receive a valid written claim or demand for payment under this bank guarantee on or before <<insert expiry date>> failing which our liability under the guarantee will automatically cease.

9.3. Format for Undertaking

[On the letterhead of the organization]

No. Date:

To,

The Director,
Directorate of Good Governance & Information Technology, Punjab
2nd Floor, Academic Block, MGSIPA,
Sector - 26, Chandigarh - 160019

Subject: Self Declaration for not being blacklisted, insolvent and convicted of any criminal offense.

Ref: Your Bid Ref. No.: **DGGIT/Helpline/2025/2** dated <xxx>

Dear Sir/ Madam,

We confirm that as on the date of submission of this bid: -

A. Our company / firm is not under a declaration of ineligibility for corrupt or fraudulent practices and is not blacklisted by any State Govt. / Central Govt. / Board, Corporations and Government Societies / PSU for any reason as on date of bid submission.
B. Our company / firm is not insolvent, in receivership, bankrupt or being wound up, not have its affairs administered by court or judicial officer, not have its business activities suspended and is not the subject of legal proceedings for any of the foregoing reasons.
C. And our directors, partners and officers have not been convicted of any criminal offense related to their professional conduct or the making of false statements or misrepresentations as to their qualifications within a period of last 5 years as on 31/03/2025 or not have been otherwise disqualified pursuant to debarment proceedings.

Yours Sincerely,

Signature of Authorized Signatory
Name and designation of Signatory:
Name of Firm:
Address:

9.4. Parameters for Call Audit

Quality Parameters					
Parameter		Mark Down Reaso	SCORE		
				Quality Parameters	
		Max			Total
1	Opening/Greeting	10	1	Did the agent mention the "Welcome to Punjab State Helpline"	4
			2	Did the agent mention his/her name?	3
			3	Did the agent mention "How may I help you today?"	3
2	Grievance	20	4	Did the agent let the citizen speak about the matter for which he called	4
			5	Did the agent understand the problem?	4
			6	Did the agent paraphrase the exact problem?	4
			7	Did the agent probe the matter clearly?	4
			8	Did the agent asked the relevant probing questions?	4
3	Capturing the Citizen information	10	9	Did the agent captured the demographic details as per the requirement of the CRM?	5
			10	Did the agent checked the pervious case log?	5
4	Issue resolution	30	11	Did the agent made proper case log in the CRM?	6
			12	Did the agent gave proper resolution to the citizen?	6
			13	Did the agent mention the Grievance id to the citizen?	6
			14	Did the agent tag the complaint with the proper department?	6
			15	Did the agent tag the complaint with the proper Category?	6
5	Call Hold	5	16	Proper use of call hold	3
			17	Manage Dead air	2
6	Etiquette/Soft Skill	20	18	Offer empathy	4
			19	Did the agent display a professional manner throughout the call?	4
			20	Did the agent sounded clear, Enthusiasm & confident throughout the call?	4
			21	Did the agent refrain from using technical jargon throughout the call?	4
			22	Complaint Confirmation,Additional info	4
7	Closing	5	23	Close the call appropriately with thanks notes.	5

9.5. Minimum Specification of All-in-one

SN	Feature	Minimum Specifications
1.	Processor	14th Generation Intel Core i3
2.	Graphics	Integrated Graphics Card
3.	Operating System	Pre-installed Genuine Microsoft Windows 11 Professional (64 bit)
4.	Memory (RAM)	16 GB DDR5
5.	Storage Disk	256 GB SSD
6.	Display	21 inch or above
		Resolution - 1920 x 1080p
		IPS / VA, Anti Glare
7.	Connectivity	10/100/1000 Gigabit Ethernet Port
		Integrated WiFi 6
		Bluetooth 5

9.6. **Guidelines on Preventing and Combating Fraud and Corruption in Program-for-Results Financing' dated February 1, 2012 and revised on July 10, 2015 (the Anti-Corruption Guidelines** *https://www.worldbank.org/en/programs/program-for-results-financing#3)*

9.6.1. These Guidelines address Fraud and Corruption that may occur in connection with the preparation and implementation of programs financed, in whole or in part, by the International Bank for Reconstruction and Development (IBRD) or the International Development Association (IDA) through Program-for-Results Financing. They set out the general principles, requirements, and sanctions applicable to such programs.

9.6.2. The Loan Agreement providing for the Loan governs the legal relationships between the Borrower and the Bank with respect to the Program for which the Loan is made. The responsibility for the implementation of the Program under the Loan Agreement, including the primary responsibility for preventing and combating Fraud and Corruption, rests with the Borrower. The Bank, for its part, has a fiduciary duty under its Articles of Agreement to "make arrangements to ensure that the proceeds of any loan are used only for the purposes for which the loan was granted, with due attention to considerations of economy and efficiency and without regard to political or other non-economic influences or considerations." These Guidelines constitute an important element of those arrangements and are made applicable to the preparation and implementation of the Program as provided in the Loan Agreement.

9.6.3. Recognizing that Fraud and Corruption leads to wasted resources and undermines development effectiveness, the Bank and the Borrower agree that all individuals and entities participating in the Program must observe the highest standard of ethics and, specifically, that all such persons and entities must take all appropriate measures to prevent and combat Fraud and Corruption, and refrain from engaging in Fraud and Corruption, in connection with the Program. In furtherance of these principles and purposes, the Bank and the Borrower further agree and commit to undertaking the actions set out in these Guidelines for the purpose of preventing and combating Fraud and Corruption in connection with the Program.

9.6.4. These Guidelines address the following defined practices in connection with the Program:

9.6.4.1. A “corrupt practice” is the offering, giving, receiving, or soliciting, directly or indirectly, of anything of value to influence improperly the actions of another party.

9.6.4.2. A “fraudulent practice” is any act or omission, including a misrepresentation, that knowingly or recklessly misleads, or attempts to mislead, a party to obtain a financial or other benefit or to avoid an obligation.

9.6.4.3. A “collusive practice” is an arrangement between two or more parties designed to achieve an improper purpose, including to influence improperly the actions of another party.

9.6.4.4. A “coercive practice” is impairing or harming, or threatening to impair or harm, directly or indirectly, any party or the property of the party to influence improperly the actions of a party.

9.6.4.5. An “obstructive practice” is (i) deliberately destroying, falsifying, altering or concealing of evidence material to the investigation or making false statements to investigators in order to materially impede a Bank investigation into allegations of a corrupt, fraudulent, coercive, or collusive practice; and/or threatening, harassing or intimidating any party to prevent it from disclosing its knowledge of matters relevant to the investigation or from pursuing the investigation, or (ii) acts intended to materially impede the exercise of the Bank’s contractual rights of audit or access to information.

9.6.4.6. The above practices, as so defined, are referred to collectively in these Guidelines as “Fraud and Corruption.”

9.6.4.7. In furtherance of the above-stated purpose and general principles, except as otherwise agreed in writing by the Borrower and the Bank, the Borrower:

9.6.4.7.1. takes all appropriate measures to ensure that the Program is carried out in accordance with these Guidelines;

9.6.4.7.2. takes all appropriate measures to prevent Fraud and Corruption in connection with the Program, including (but not limited to) adopting and implementing appropriate fiduciary and administrative practices and institutional arrangements;

9.6.4.7.3. promptly informs the Bank of all credible and material allegations or other indications of Fraud and Corruption in connection with the Program that come to its attention, together with the investigative and other actions that the Borrower proposes to take with respect thereto;

9.6.4.7.4. unless otherwise agreed by the Borrower and the Bank with respect to a particular case, takes timely and appropriate action to investigate such allegations and indications; reports to the Bank on the actions taken in any such investigation, at such intervals as may be agreed between the Borrower and the Bank; and, promptly upon the completion of any such investigation, reports to the Bank the findings thereof;

9.6.4.7.5. if the Borrower or the Bank determines that any person or entity has engaged in Fraud and Corruption in connection with the Program, takes timely and appropriate action, satisfactory to the Bank, to remedy or otherwise address the situation and prevent its recurrence; provided that nothing in this sub-paragraph (e) or in sub-paragraph (d) above obligates the Borrower to take action in direct contradiction of the applicable law of the Member Count.

9.6.4.7.6. cooperates fully with representatives of the Bank in any inquiry conducted by the Bank into allegations or other indications of Fraud and Corruption in connection with the Program, and takes all appropriate measures to ensure the full cooperation of relevant persons and entities subject to the Borrower's jurisdiction in such inquiry; and

9.6.4.7.7. ensures that any person or entity debarred or suspended by the Bank is not awarded a contract under or otherwise allowed to participate in the Program during the period of such debarment or suspension.

9.6.4.8. In furtherance of the above-stated purpose and general principles, except as otherwise agreed in writing by the Borrower and the Bank, the Bank:

9.6.4.8.1. promptly informs the Borrower of all credible and material allegations or other indications of Fraud and Corruption in

connection with the Program that come to its attention, consistent with Bank policies and procedures;

9.6.4.8.2. in cases where the Bank determines it necessary to do so to fulfill its fiduciary duty, may conduct an inquiry into such allegations or other indications, independently of or in collaboration with the Borrower;

9.6.4.8.3. reports to the Borrower on the outcome of any such inquiry; and

9.6.4.8.4. may sanction any individual or entity other than the Member Country if at any time the Bank determines that such individual or entity has engaged in Fraud and Corruption in connection with the Program or any other Bank-financed activity, or is otherwise subject to sanction pursuant to its prevailing policies and procedures.

9.6.4.9. **Miscellaneous**

9.6.4.9.1. For avoidance of doubt, nothing in these Guidelines is intended to restrict or otherwise affect the Member Country's sovereign right to investigate, prosecute or take any other action in furtherance of its own laws and regulations. Any inquiries conducted by the Bank pursuant to these Guidelines are administrative in nature, for the purpose of determining compliance with the Bank's policies, directives and procedures. Inquiries include, but are not limited to, the review of relevant accounts, records and other documents, and interviews with relevant persons.

9.6.4.9.2. Without prejudice to any provision hereof, in the event that any action to be taken by the Borrower under these Guidelines may conflict with requirements of the applicable laws and regulations of the Member Country, the Bank and the Borrower will consult with a view to identifying and agreeing on alternative actions that will avoid such conflict while ensuring compliance herewith.

9.6.4.9.3. The provisions of these Guidelines do not limit any other rights, remedies or obligations of the Bank or the Borrower under the Loan Agreement or any other document to which the Bank and the Borrower are both parties.